



Erin Chute
Commissioner

Alexandra Vecchio
Director

TOWN OF BROOKLINE
Massachusetts
DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS
P S D O P S P D S O

**PARK AND RECREATION COMMISSION AMORY PLAYGROUND
DESIGN REVIEW MEETING
WEDNESDAY, MAY 1, 2024, FROM 6:00 pm- 7:45 pm**

Join online via Zoom:

https://brooklinema.zoomgov.com/webinar/register/WN_ybxyXWKGKQfm8k8b_ioJh1Q

Join by phone: 1 669 254 5252 or +1 646 828 7666 or +1 551 285 1373 or +1 669 216 1590

Webinar ID: 161 925 8960 **Passcode:** 63878383

MEETING FILES LINK

<https://www.brooklinema.gov/DocumentCenter/Index/5401>

AGENDA

6:00 PM	WELCOME AND CALL MEETING TO ORDER
6:05 PM	OVERVIEW OF PROJECT AND SCOPE OF WORK
6:15 PM	PRESENTATION OF EXISTING CONDITIONS
6:45 PM	COMMUNITY DISCUSSION AND FEEDBACK
7:30 PM	NEXT STEPS AND UPCOMING MEETING DATES
7:45 PM	ADJOURNMENT

From: [Uri Mariash](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Preserving clay courts in Brookline
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 6:43:27 AM

Hi Jessie,

As a Brookline resident and a former town meet member. I wanted to express my support for the preservation of our clay courts. I have been using and seeing the courts provide an opportunity for people in our community to engage in tennis regardless of the summer rains and do it in a fun and slow paced environment. I hope the town can continue providing that.

Thank you,

Uri

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From: [Catherine B](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 7:36:00 AM

Hi,

I learned to play on har-tru (green clay) courts and love its benefits. It's easier on the joints (something I appreciate as I'm now on the cusp of middle age, and hope to be able to continue playing tennis), and on the game side, it has an awesome response to spin :-). Also, they allow for play even in drizzle, which has been big this past year. Hard courts become slick much sooner than clay.

I was ecstatic to be able to find a great adult program *on clay* now my kids are older and in school all day *in our town!*

It's nearly impossible to find courts that are in this beautiful shape, and so accessible. They are affordable, which is great for seniors with a budget (I have met many lovely retirees in my classes), and the aforementioned joint benefits to clay are also important for them.

Please, please save these courts. My kids love playing there and so do I!

Catherine

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From: [Michael Siegel](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay - Senior Tennis Players can't play in Brookline without it.
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 11:54:14 AM

Jessie,

I am a senior tennis player that has used Amory courts for over 20 years. I have lived in Brookline for that time and I could not play in Brookline without the clay (knees, back and other injuries). Many players at the courts are in the same condition. I would be happy to even pay more to play there –PLEASE THE COURTS MUST REMAIN CLAY – so many people cannot play on hard courts!

Best,

Michael

Michael Siegel
Principal Research Scientist
Director, Cybersecurity at MIT Sloan (CAMS)
(<https://cams.mit.edu>)
Sloan School of Management
Massachusetts Institute of Technology
245 First St., E94-1567
Cambridge, MA 02142
Cell: 617-620-6294

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From: [Axel Stern](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 1:08:06 PM

Hi Jessie,

I've heard that there is a potential to convert the tennis courts at Amory park to hard court. My preference is to keep them as clay courts. It makes the sport more accessible to people with knee and back issues as the clay is much softer and allows more people to play the sport. Not to mention, there are plenty of hard court options in Brookline but no other clay courts. It's part of what makes Amory so special!

Best regards,
Axel Stern

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From: [Colleen Bognet](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory clay courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 10:47:12 AM

Dear Jesse,

I am writing to voice my strong opposition to converting Amory to hard court. There are several hard courts all around Brookline, but there is only ONE clay court, and I'd like to keep it that way.

Colleen Bognet
14 Amory Street
Brookline
Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Daihung Do](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 11:58:33 AM

Hi,

I have been a Brookline resident for 10 years. I live at 312 Dean Rd. I am writing to you to express my support for keeping Amory a clay tennis court. There are plenty of other hard courts for tennis. Unfortunately, many of these courts have been taken over by pickle ball players. I'm concerned that converting Amory to clay courts will make it even more difficult to play tennis on a tennis court. Thank you for your time.

Daihung Do

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From: [Goldberg, Marcia B.,MD](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory clay courts
Date: Sunday, April 21, 2024 9:22:35 PM

Dear Jessie Waisnor,

I have lived in Brookline for almost 50 years. I am writing to express my extremely strong support for maintaining clay tennis courts at Amory Park.

I am 66 years old (and a physician). I play on the clay courts at least twice a week from when they open in April to when they close in October and have been doing so for close to 20 years. Playing on clay is far gentler to the body (particularly the knee joints) than playing on hard courts. Thus, the existence of the Amory clay courts has allowed me (and many other Brookline citizens) to remain active and healthy as I (we) age.

The clay courts at Amory are an extraordinary public resource. For those who prefer hard courts, there are numerous hardcourts in other Brookline locations. Please keep Amory courts clay.

Marcia Goldberg
155 Davis Avenue
Brookline

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From: [Vivek Goyal](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory clay courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 12:23:44 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I am writing to add my voice to the chorus of people hoping that Brookline will maintain the *clay* courts at Amory Park. The community has a lot of hard courts. Clay courts don't just provide variety, they hugely important joint-health advantages to many in our community. Please save the clay.

Best wishes,
Vivek

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Vivek K Goyal ([hear name](#)), Professor and Associate Chair of Doctoral Programs
<http://vivekgoyal.org/> Boston Univ. Electrical & Computer Engineering
8 Saint Mary's St, PHO 324
Boston, MA 02215-2421

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From: [Genderson Candamo](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay tennis Court.
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 6:09:02 PM

Dear Ms. Jessie Waisnor ,

I am a resident of Brookline for over 8 years.

One of the joys of being in Brookline where I am , is the close proximity to the Amory clay tennis courts.

At my advanced age (66) playing tennis at clay courts is very important to keep me healthy and active.

I've been a homeowner and dutifully paying my taxes to the town of Brookline for 8 years and will gladly continue to do so .

It's been brought to my attention that the town is considering taking away the only clay courts in the entire town and paving them to make another hard court tennis/pickle ball facility.

I would like to express my strong objection to this possibility for the following reasons :

- 1 People at my age group have a hard time playing tennis on hard courts .
- 2 We would like to continue playing tennis on clay courts and not on hard courts (much easier on the knees and on falls)
- 3 We would not want to switch to playing pickle ball , since that game has a very high injury rate (according to many medical professionals) especially in my age group.
- 4 As you well know the noise factor on pickle ball courts has made national news and towns have been sued for that reason. The Amory courts being in a dense residential neighborhood would generate a lot of objections from the neighborhood due to the noise whether it is tennis or pickle ball. I am sure the town of Brookline would not wish to be dealing with unnecessary litigation due to this issue.
- 5 The town of Brookline already has many hard tennis court/pickle ball facilities . The Amory courts are the only clay court facility in town. This is similar to the city of Newton situation , where they have one clay court facility in Newton Centre and many hard tennis court/pickle ball facilities. As far as I know they have no plans to change this popular situation.

Please Ms. Waisnor consider our strong objections to this idea of eliminating the only clay courts at the town of Brookline , for the sake of the elderly population that enjoys playing tennis and can only play at clay courts , the neighborhood peace and quiet and the many members that participate in this uniquely healthy activity of tennis and make up a wonderful community.

Thank you for your attention.
Genderson Candamo

Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Scott Berman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay Tennis Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:22:38 AM
Attachments: [image001.png](#)

Jessie,

I'm writing to add my name to the list of Brookline residents **STRONGLY** in support of maintaining clay tennis courts at Amory. I don't know if you're a tennis player, but if so you would know that for many of us players who are getting a bit older, it is simply not viable to play tennis regularly on hard courts without sustaining an injury. I'm 57 and personally I love to play at least 4-5 days per week (especially in summer) – but I had back surgery last year and I'm only able to do so if I'm able to play on clay, which has much less wear and tear on my body (back, knees, etc.). A number of the people I play with have the same limitation, and some simply can't play on hard courts, ever. So please understand that it's not as simple as just playing on hardcourts instead of on clay. For many people, the alternative will be not playing at all – or at least playing far less.

It's precisely because the Amory courts are clay that I pay the membership every summer to play there. There are several hard courts closer to my house, and if Amory was converted to hard courts there would be no reason to play there (though I'm not sure how much I could play at the other hard courts either, as described above).

Finally, while it may not be a popular view for everyone, I would personally be willing to pay a higher fee to maintain clay courts at Amory. If money is what is holding this up, I would recommend that the town consider simply increasing the membership fee. I suspect many other residents are capable of paying more, and perhaps there could be a financial assistance program for those who are not?

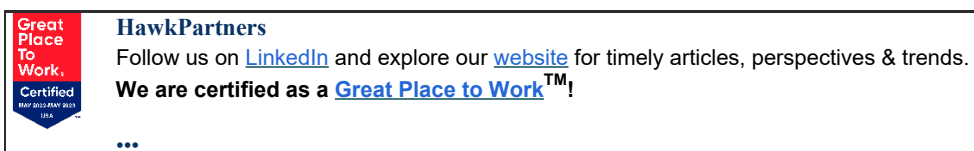
Please let me know if you have any questions or would like additional information/details. If you are a tennis player then you already know that the Amory clay courts are unique in that they are only of the only options for people like me to be able to play regularly without joining an expensive, exclusive club like Longwood. And if you're not a tennis player, please do take a few moments to talk to some – as I think it would help to understand why this is important.

Thank you for listening.

Scott Berman

Scott Berman (He/Him/His)

781.248.8572 mobile
617.576.4702 office



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From: [Steve Patterson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [REDACTED]
Subject: Amory Clay Tennis Courts
Date: Sunday, April 21, 2024 4:57:15 PM

Dear Jessie,

I am writing to you to as a longtime fan and user of the clay tennis courts @ Amory Park. They are a Brookline treasure! Changing them to hard-courts would be a terrible loss!

The softer clay surface is a god-send to players of all skills...particularly as players age. Further, in the high summer heat, the clay courts offer a kinder/cooler surface and as a result are preferred by most players.

Finally, Brookline already has at least 22 hard-courts spread throughout the town that I am aware of: 7 Waldstein, 5 Baker, 3 Warren Field, 3 Lawrence, 3 Ruffin Ridley, 1 Coolidge Park. Preserving the sole clay courts at Amory allows for players of all skills and ages to experience and enjoy tennis on a second surface...one that is favored, indeed loved by so many.

Please share my very strong opinion that the Amory courts should remain clay. Thank you.

Sincerely,
Steve Patterson
36 Amory St.
617-480-6674
Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Sophie Cohen](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Court
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 8:55:34 AM

Hi,

I'm writing to express my deep concern with changing Amory to hard courts. Amory is the only public clay court in the area, and the only space devoted to tennis. It's integral that it remain this way, and not become yet another place where tennis is looked over in favor of pickle ball. Unfortunately, at the public courts, pickle ball players don't follow the same etiquette as tennis players, and it's nearly impossible to find an open tennis court nowadays that is not Amory Court. Please refrain from taking our clay courts away.

Thank you,
Sophie Cohen

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From: [Karen Shaw](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 7:48:14 AM

Please keep the beautiful clay tennis courts. They have been such a treasure. I played there for many years when I lived in Brookline and continued when I moved to Brighton.

Thank you
Karen J Shaw

Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Eisenberg, Mark P.,MD](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:30:57 AM

Dear Ms Waisnor,

I am writing in support of keeping the clay courts at Amory. I was a 30 year Brookline resident who moved to Cambridge 1 year ago. I continue to return to Amory several times a week to play tennis with my Brookline partners. If the courts are converted to hardcourts, I won't bother to make the trip across town.

I'm 72 years old. The surface is forgiving of the arthritis in my knees and hips. The slowness works well for all levels of players. These courts are one of the very few public clay courts available and help make Brookline a unique town.

I appreciate you taking my concerns into consideration.

Yours, Mark

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From: [Suzanne Modigliani](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Sergio Modigliani](#)
Subject: Amory Courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 1:57:33 PM

Hello

We live at 1160 Beacon St. on the first floor and are direct abutters to the Amory courts, a true asset to our community.

We are very concerned about the possibility of the conversion to hard courts where the sound is much greater. And the potential of pickleball noise would be unacceptable, to say the least.

I recognize the maintenance of clay courts is more expensive. But that's part of why they are a treasure.

Sincerely,

Suzanne and Sergio Modigliani

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From: [Thecla Ree](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory courts resurfacing
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 6:15:17 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor:

It's come to my attention that the town is leaning toward converting the Amory clay courts to a hard surface. I respectfully ask that you reconsider.

Clay is much, much easier on the body — especially the joints. It's truly a joy to see so many different generations play at Amory. I have several tennis friends who are well into their 80s who can play on the clay regularly — and they do many times every week.

Brookline offers many wonderful, enrichment opportunities for the younger generation (excellent schools, libraries, playgrounds, programs of all kinds). For a town with the resources of Brookline, it's surprising how little there is for our community of aging adults, however.

I certainly don't want to turn this into a pickleball vs. tennis turf war. But, I understand that the pickleball community is eager to convert the 6 clay courts to hard courts, which will increase the number of pickle courts by 12. With so many existing places for pickleballers to play currently, are 12 more courts in Brookline for 1 sport really needed? Especially at the expense of our aging population?

Amory Park is a beautiful, often quiet greenspace for us to walk through or relax in for many of non-tennis players, including those who don't have yards or outdoor space in our buildings. The noise that pickleball makes would destroy the peaceful experience, as it has in other neighborhoods where pickleball is played near private residences.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,
Thecla Ree

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From: [Monica Candamo](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory keep the clay
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 6:17:02 PM

Dear Ms. Jessie Waisnor ,

I am a resident of Brookline over 8 years.

One of the joys of being in Brookline where I am , is the close proximity to the Amory clay tennis courts.

At my advanced age (59 years) playing tennis at clay courts is very important to keep me healthy and active.

I've been a homeowner and dutifully paying my taxes to the town of Brookline .

It's been brought to my attention that the town is considering taking away the only clay courts in the entire town and paving them to make another hard court tennis/pickle ball facility.

I would like to express my strong objection to this possibility for the following reasons :

- 1 People at my age group have a hard time playing tennis on hard courts .
- 2 We would like to continue playing tennis on clay courts and not on hard courts (much easier on the knees , back and on falls)
- 3 We would not want to switch to playing pickle ball , since that game has a very high injury rate (according to many medical professionals) especially no only in a group of people my age and even younger.
- 4 As you well know the noise factor on pickle ball courts has made national news and towns have been sued for that reason. The Amory courts being in a dense residential neighborhood would generate a lot of objections from the neighborhood due to the noise whether it is tennis or pickle ball. I am sure the town of Brookline would not wish to be dealing with unnecessary litigation due to this issue.
- 5 The town of Brookline already has many hard tennis court/pickle ball facilities .
The Amory courts are the only clay court facility in town.
This is similar to the city of Newton situation , where they have one clay court facility in Newton Centre and many hard tennis court/pickle ball facilities.
As far as I know they have no plans to change this popular situation.

Please Ms. Waisnor consider our strong objections to this idea of eliminating the only clay courts at the town of Brookline , for the sake of the elderly population that enjoys playing tennis and can only play at clay courts , the neighborhood peace and quiet and the many members that participate in this uniquely healthy activity of tennis and make up a wonderful community.

Warmers regards

Monica Obradovich Candamo.

Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Hadrien Kitabgi Khan](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory park - Clay tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:44:23 AM

Dear Jessie,

I hope this message finds you well.

I wanted to take a moment to express my support for the clay tennis courts we have at Amory park. As avid players and enthusiasts, my wife and I cherish the unique charm and benefits that clay courts bring to our game. Clay courts offer a distinct playing experience, fostering skill development, strategic play, and agility on the court. Moreover, the forgiving surface reduces the risk of injuries and allows players to enjoy longer, more dynamic rallies.

I believe that continuing to invest in the maintenance of our clay courts is crucial for preserving the quality of our playing environment and ensuring the continued enjoyment of all tennis players in Brookline. Let's work together to prioritize the care of our clay courts, ensuring they remain a cherished asset for our tennis community for years to come.

Thank you for your understanding.

Best,
Hadrien

Hadrien KITABGI KHAN


+1 (857) 352 4228

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From: [Russell Frye](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 4:42:19 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I grew up in Brookline and went to Brookline High School. I was living in Boston until 2006 when I decided to move back to Brookline, primarily because of Amory Park's clay tennis courts. As I have aged, I found that a clay surface was much, much more forgiving on my body, especially my joints. I experienced repeated injuries playing tennis on hard courts, but clay has been much kinder to me.

Public clay tennis courts are not available in most communities, so for me, the loss of this resource would force me to look elsewhere for a home. I live in FL during the winter so that I can play tennis year-round, on clay, and when I return to MA in the summer I participate in Net Results clinics at least 3 times a week and I play socially over the weekend. Tennis is a major part of my lifestyle and my health initiatives.

Clay tennis courts should, IMHO, be considered a health benefit for the older community. By 'older', I mean anyone over 40. Playing on clay vs. hard courts can result in a reduction in serious injuries and a longer active lifetime.

The Amory Park Clay Tennis Courts are a gem for the Town. Please protect this resource for the benefit of the Town and its residents.

best regards,

Russell H Frye
121 Centre Street PH1
Brookline, MA 02446
1 617 851 7877

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From: [Jessica Margolis](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park Clay Courts
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 2:39:19 PM

Dear Jessie,

I am writing because it came to my attention that the Town of Brookline is considering replacing the Amory Park clay tennis courts with hard courts. I have been a resident of Brookline and member for the Amory tennis community for the last 10 years. I am also an avid tennis player and former Division I college player.

It would be a huge disappointment for me and the greater community to no longer be able to play on clay courts in my neighborhood. There are so many benefits to clay courts. It is easier on the joints, cooler in summertime, more fun to play on, with longer points and slightly slower pace than hard courts, aesthetically pleasing to the eye, and more readily playable after a rain shower.

It is truly special that Brookline has public clay courts. There are very few public clay court tennis facilities in the country, which makes the Amory courts exceptionally invaluable to the town.

Replacing these clay courts with hard courts would not only change the playing experience and accessible due to injuries, but it would also diminish the overall charm of the park facilities. Further, I am concerned that many of my playing partners would no longer play at the park if the courts were converted to hard. I am not certain I would continue to play on hard courts, either. It would be devastating to lose this community who is so passionate about tennis.

In conclusion, I urge you to consider the impact of this decision and to advocate for maintaining the clay courts.

Thank you for considering,
Jessica Margolis

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From: [Nora Sanders](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park Project - Please keep the clay!
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 9:14:54 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I'm writing to urge the town and Park and Recreation Commission to maintain the clay court tennis facilities at Amory Park.

I have been a resident of Brookline for 15+ years, and I have played tennis at Amory Park for even longer than that - Amory Park was one of the reasons that my husband and I moved from Boston to this particular area of Brookline. We have come to know that the town and Park & Recreation Department take great care of the many wonderful green spaces, parks and recreational areas in Brookline.

I strongly urge the town to maintain the clay court tennis facilities at Amory Park and to not replace them with hard court facilities:

1. *If* hard courts were to be put in, I would first and foremost be concerned about the environmental impact to the adjacent baseball fields and abutting property owners. Clay courts have the benefit of offering drainage while hard courts would act much like an asphalt parking lot: huge amounts of rainwater would run off into the adjacent lower-lying areas, leading to flooded driveways/basements and unplayable fields.

2. If the town seeks cost savings, hard courts are not necessarily the answer. Hard courts will not generate revenue in the same way because many tennis players place a higher value on access to a clay surface for health/physical concerns. I, like many others, do not currently pay to play on outdoor hard courts anywhere, but I happily pay to play at Amory because of the clay. So, it is unclear whether the loss in revenue will be offset by any cost savings. Even the maintenance costs may not be appreciably different. While clay courts require seasonal maintenance and hard courts may initially require sealing just a few cracks, hard courts must eventually be completely re-surfaced sooner than a clay court would need the same level of maintenance. Given New England freeze/thaw cycles, new cracks will undoubtedly sprout on a yearly basis. Any cost/revenue projections should be modeled over the life of the court. The city of Newton has successfully managed clay courts for years - perhaps they can be a reference.

Thank you for all your efforts on this project -

Sincerely,
Nora Sanders
15 Chilton St

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From: [Jesse Hefter](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park Renovation Project
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 8:30:41 PM

Hi Jessie:

I recently saw a thread of emails from our Friends of Amory Tennis group about the renovation project at Amory.

I see from the DRC report (March 20, 2024) that you are the Project Engineer for this work.

I am wondering where the impetus came from to consider converting the clay courts to hard surfaces with associated pickleball markings from planning to renovate the existing clay courts to improved clay courts.

Thanks,
Jesse
781-771-2618
TMM, P14
Pedestrian Advisory Committee
Moderator's Committee on PFAS
Candidate - School Committee

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From: [Cynthia Cook](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 11:02:51 AM

I am writing to urge town leaders to maintain the clay tennis courts at Amory Park and not convert them to a hard surface. These clay courts hold a special place in the town's array of recreation opportunities. There are numerous hard courts throughout our parks but Amory offers the only place where tennis players can experience this unique surface which offers an entirely different experience of the game. Those who frequent the clay courts are by and large serious players who are courteous and careful of their surroundings. Professionally administered and maintained by NetResults, the Amory clay courts are a jewel that should be cherished and preserved.

Cynthia Cook
4 Euston Street
Brookline

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From: [David Kagle](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park Tennis Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 1:29:56 PM

I am writing to express my concern about possible changes to the current clay tennis courts at Amory Park. As a longtime homeowner in Brookline, I appreciate the many advantages of such a great community...great schools, terrific people, wonderful schools and the many communal amenities. Among these, the courts at Amory stands out as a place where neighbors from all over Brookline, both young and old, get together on a regular basis to enjoy this wonderful resource. Its unique quality (clay) allow senior players to compete among ourselves and with younger players, as the game play tends to be slower and the surface more forgiving. Nothing will ever compensate for older bones and joints, but this surface allows intergenerational play in a way that hard surface cannot match. Additionally, clay courts are playable for a much greater percentage of time, as hard courts need to dry thoroughly before they can be played. As the past few summers have shown, we are getting much wetter spring and summers as a result of climate change. As a community, we should consider adaptation to climate change as part of changes that we wish to make. As for cost, there is no particular advantage to changing to a hard surface, as the cost of maintenance is offset by the nominal fees that are paid by users for this unique resource and there is a considerable cost to changing over to hard surface, which imposes a further cost on the community, as those services need to be refinished every few years. From a cost perspective, it seems that the funds to convert the self sustaining clay surfaces would be better used in resurfacing the many long neglected hard surface courts throughout the town.

As both a Pickleball and tennis player, I understand that there may be a perceived need to create more Pickleball courts. I understand that one of the greatest challenges in creating Pickleball courts is the noise factor, with nearby apartments objecting to the proximity of the courts. It is a known fact that sound intensity decreases as the square of the distance from the source. That is, Pickleball played 60 ft away from an apartment will be only 1/25 (4%) the intensity of that being played 10 ft from the apartment. In the case of Amory, there are apartments sited directly in front of the courts, making this site unsuitable for Pickleball, whereas other existing hard courts are further away, thereby greatly decreasing the impact of the noise.

I strongly urge you to not approve any changes to the Amory courts, and to use any funds that are available for such a project to the resurfacing of other courts in the area, perhaps with a consideration of using some of these for Pickleball.

Sincerely,

David Kagle
1810 Beacon Street
Brookline

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From: [Deborah J Cohen](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park Tennis Renovation
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 12:09:25 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

As a Brookline taxpayer, Amory Park neighbor, and tennis player, I'm writing to express my strong support for retaining Amory's clay courts—the only publicly available clay in the area. I also endorse exploring hybrid clay surfaces (e.g., CaliClay.net), that would retain the clay but might prove more cost-effective and require less water use.

The Amory facility is truly one-of-a-kind, and draws players from all over Brookline and the metro area. By contrast, there are multiple playgrounds around town, with various options for hard courts and pickleball. If this opportunity to improve Amory Park were to result in more asphalt and more racket (of the highly audible, pickleball variety), it would be an unconscionable downgrading of a treasured and scarce public resource in a residential area.

Thanks for your work and for the opportunity to comment,

Deborah Cohen

Deborah Cohen
1140 Beacon #302
Brookline 02446

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From: [Cindy Lipsky](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory redesign
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 1:33:21 PM

Hi Jessie,

I'm an avid tennis player, as well as an avid pickleball player in Brookline. I always describe the courts at Amory as a gem of Brookline. I feel so lucky to live in a town that offers public clay courts. That just doesn't happen too often.

The clay courts at Amory have a big following. Many of us have been playing at Amory for years. Many friendships and even marriages have come from the camaraderie of playing at the clay courts in Brookline. It is truly a special place and people come from neighboring towns to play there.

Brookline has many hard courts, but I've never felt the special camaraderie at those, that we have at Amory. The clay is so much easier on the joints. As the population ages, it's nice that we can still play the game we love and not take such a beating on our joints because of the softer clay surface.

I could go on for pages, but just wanted to voice my support for keeping Amory clay.

Thank you.

Cindy Lipsky

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From: [Brian Malone](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis - Keep the Clay!
Date: Sunday, April 21, 2024 9:40:49 PM

Dear Ms. Jessie Waisnor,

I moved to Brookline two years ago. One of the great bonuses of living in this town has been becoming a member of the Amory clay courts. I recently heard that the town is considering turning the clay courts into another set of hard courts and wanted to join the many others who have voiced objections and concerns.

There are many other hard courts throughout Brookline and the price of Amory membership would not be worth playing on more hard courts with so many free alternatives. The primary draw of Amory is the well maintained set of clay courts. Furthermore, the switch to hard courts is likely to draw a lot of pickleball players, adding additional complications, drawbacks, and potential pitfalls. The noise of pickleball in such a dense area will impact neighbors and risk litigation and campaigning against the town, something Brookline doesn't need. It will draw much larger numbers of people to Amory, making it harder to get courts and all but guaranteeing the Amory membership worthless. Finally, a large number of my fellow Amory members are older and clay is a much better, safer, and healthier surface to enjoy tennis on at that age. Destroying clay courts and developing hard courts will destroy the years of goodwill that has been created between the older players and the town of Brookline and, to be frank, the suggestion of this plan has already started to damage that.

Having spoken to a large number of fellow Amory members at this point I haven't met a single one who isn't wholly disappointed in this plan. Please take into account the wonderful community that already exists at Amory and would unlikely continue to do so if this change goes ahead.

Kind regards,

--

Brian Malone

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From: [Paul Sax](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 5:20:15 PM

Hi Jessie,

I'm a longtime Brookline resident (1994!) and moved here in part because of the beautiful Amory Park -- the tennis courts in particular! These clay courts are true urban gems, offering a wonderful experience for frequent players like myself. I am very happy to pay the annual fee for court membership, and have done so for many years. When I tell my other tennis-loving friends from other towns that we have access to them, they are truly jealous.

Please keep the courts clay after the renovation! There are many ways to make this work.

Many thanks,

Paul Sax

78 Crowninshield

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From: [Alan D. Grossman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Saturday, April 20, 2024 6:11:03 PM

Dear Jessie (cc Alexandra),

I'm writing to strongly support the continued presence of clay tennis courts at Amory Playground. Conversion to hard courts during the impending renovations would have a large negative impact me and many others, most notably the many senior citizens who play there.

I have lived in Brookline since 1985, and initially played on the various hard courts available throughout town. Playing tennis has been and continues to be a way for me to remain active and healthy.

Now, as a senior citizen and a recipient of a heart transplant, access to clay courts is critical for me to continue to play tennis and maintain health. Clay is obviously softer than the hard courts and much more gentle on bones and joints and this is critical for many of us.

Brookline is a special community for many reasons, with a reputation for inclusivity. The public clay courts at Amory contribute to this; very few towns/cities in the northeast have clay courts available to the public. Converting Amory tennis courts to a hard surface would be a tremendous loss for the town and would have a negative impact on and exclude many of us who would like to continue to play tennis in Brookline and need to play on a surface softer than the many other courts in town.

Please do all you can to ensure the installation of clay tennis courts when Amory Playground is renovated.

Thank you.

Sincerely,
Alan

Alan D. Grossman
155 Davis Ave.
Brookline, MA 02445
(617) 519-9150
[REDACTED]

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From: [Allan Toledano](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 11:47:28 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

It was brought to my attention that the town of Brookline is considering transforming our beloved clay courts at Amory into hard courts.

As a Chestnut Hill (Brookline side) resident for over 30 years, I have been using the Amory courts for years and the only reason for that is that they are clay courts. I am in my late 70s, and we all know that clay courts are much healthier for aging legs and knees.

There are plenty of hard courts available in Brookline which my peers and I choose not to use because of the above. And there are already plenty of pickle ball courts all around from which to choose from. We feel that there is no point in adding any more of them, which for people of our age group, can be quite dangerous for our health because of the frequent falls.

We humbly request that the town of Brookline leave the Amory courts the way they are for the benefit of the entire Brookline population, young and old.

We thank you so much for your attention.

Sincerely,
Allan Toledano
617 650-2313
Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Catherine Burke](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 8:50:33 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I write today to urge you to keep clay tennis courts at Amory Playground as part of the upcoming renovation. I know many have written about the advantages of playing on clay in terms of wear and tear on the body, especially at older ages. I won't repeat their many points, but I will say that there is a sizable and vibrant crowd of older tennis players who are part of the Brookline — and Amory — community. As a regular player myself who is merely middle-aged, I aspire to be playing tennis as long as these individuals are. To take this resource and opportunity away from our Brookline community would be a terrible shame. I know of no other public clay courts anywhere in the Boston area. The clay courts I do know of are on the properties of private, exclusive clubs, such as The Country Club and Longwood Cricket Club. These clubs are simply not accessible to the vast majority of Brookline residents irrespective of financial means (although they would be financially out of reach to most as well).

As a confessional aside, I also enjoy pickleball with my family. There are many places we can play pickleball already. We don't need to sacrifice the Amory clay courts on the altar of pickleball. I'm sure both pastimes can co-exist peacefully.

Thank you for your consideration and your efforts on behalf of our town.

Sincerely,

Catherine Burke
Somerset Road

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From: [David Fleishman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 1:54:56 PM

Dear Jesse,

I know you have a major task in front of you regarding the renovation of Amory Park. The notion of rebuilding a clay tennis court facility must be daunting. That being said, the Clay courts are an invaluable resource for our community. In particular, they allow older players to enjoy the sport on a surface that is much more forgiving. I know I will appreciate it in my future years.

While I understand that finances are a concern, I do think the Town of Brookline can earn more money through the contract with the current vendor. NetResults makes a small fortune from a public contract and I think there is a way to generate more revenue.

Many thanks for your consideration.

Sincerely,
David Fleishman

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From: [David Haarmeyer](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#); [friends-of-amory-tennis](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 5:15:53 PM

Dear Jessie,

I am writing to strongly object to any proposal to convert Amory clay tennis courts to a hard surface. I have been fortunate to have played at the Amory courts for the over 28 years that I have lived in the community. It's not an exaggeration to say that without Amory clay courts my tennis years would have been over years earlier given that I have had a bad (ACL-torn) knee. I am 66 years old and would appreciate the opportunity to continue to play tennis as long as I can.

Amory's clay courts and Amory park together make up one of Brookline's special gems that the town should embrace and treasure. There is an abundance of hard courts, but public clay courts are extremely rare.

Any challenges related to the courts' maintenance and finance should be openly discussed. There is a strong and growing Amory tennis community that is capable and willing to step up and assist the town where and when needed.

Please let me know if you have any questions.

Kind regards,

David Haarmeyer
1569 Beacon Street, No. 54
617 877 5338

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From: [Dean Bogdanovic](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory tennis courts
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 11:54:01 AM

Dear Ms Waisnor,

I'm writing you about Amory tennis courts and the reconstruction project. Amory courts are one of few locations in Boston city area that are open to public. Clay tennis courts and hard courts offer distinct playing experiences due to their differing surface characteristics. Here are some reasons why some players might find clay courts easier or more favorable compared to hard courts:

Slower Ball Speed: Clay surfaces slow down the ball more than hard courts. This gives players extra time to reach the ball and set up their shots. This is beneficial to skill development, as well for players to improve their game tactics.

Reduced Impact on the Body: Clay is a softer surface compared to the rigidity of hard courts. This softness helps in absorbing some of the impact, potentially reducing the strain on players' joints and muscles. This makes it particularly appealing for players, as it decreases the chance of injuries and lessens the wear and tear on their bodies.

Skill Development: Playing on clay can help develop a player's patience, strategy, and overall skill set. The need to construct points carefully and adapt to slower game dynamics can enhance a player's versatility and understanding of the game.

I'm well aware of the clay courts cost, but there has been development in the technology, that make clay courts easier to install and maintain, as well cheaper. In past years, I've played on hybrid clay courts in Europe (mainly northern) and California, where they became quite popular.

I've researched the hybrid clay technology quite a bit, as was curious about the technology and saw it very applicable for Amory renovation project, as well for another club where I play.

- **Reduced Maintenance and Water Use:** Hybrid clay courts are designed to require less maintenance and use up to 60% less water than regular clay or Har-Tru courts. This is partly because their top clay surface is only about 1 inch in depth and doesn't require 24-hour underground watering or heavy daily overground watering.

- **Durability and Warranty:** These courts come with a 10-year warranty and have an expected lifespan of over 20 years with minimal maintenance. There is no need for annual scarifying or biennial resurfacing; simple brushing and occasional addition of material suffice. The basalt material used is heavier than regular clay, reducing loss due to wind or rain and not staining shoes and clothing

- **Installation Flexibility:** Hybrid clay courts can be installed on existing hard (includes existing clay courts) surfaces within approximately one week, offering a quick and flexible option for upgrading tennis court facilities

- **Environmental and Operational Advantages:** The courts save up to 70% water compared to regular clay courts and are engineered to require much less maintenance overall. This makes hybrid clay courts an eco-friendly and cost-effective option

- **Playability and Health Benefits:** Playing on hybrid clay courts offers the same advantages as traditional

clay surfaces, such as reduced stress on leg joints due to the softness underfoot, longer rallies, and better exercise from the slowness of clay. This can improve a player's patience and strategic thinking since it's harder to finish points with a single big shot

Additionally, unlike traditional clay courts, hybrid clay courts do not have some of the common disadvantages such as being slippery, which can cause leg strains and injuries, and the need for significant downtime after rain due to poor drainage

The above mentioned attributes make hybrid clay court a compelling option for Amory tennis court renovation, combining the playability of clay with reduced operational costs and environmental impact.

One hybrid clay court company that caught my attention is CaliClay.net.

Regards,

Dean Bogdanovic

Brookline resident and Amory tennis court player since 1999

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From: [Debbie Rosenthal](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 2:28:13 PM

Hi Jessie-

my name is Debbie Rosenthal and I have lived in Brookline for the past 13 years and played at the Amory tennis courts. It is my understanding that there is discussion about converting the clay surface to a hard court.

I am vehemently against this as there are several hard courts in Brookline to choose from and only one clay court at Amory. Clay is much easier on your knees and with an aging community in Brookline, this is very important to keep in mind. We've developed a strong community at this court and are dedicated to its upkeep as a clay court.

You would certainly lose a lot of players with the conversion to hard courts, especially since you are still going to charge to play there and every other hard court is free.

I truly hope the decision is made to keep Amory a clay court. If not, I will certainly not be playing there.

Kind regards,
Debbie

Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Joseph Hoffee](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 7:47:30 AM

Good Morning,

I'm writing this to add my voice to the objections of the possible conversion of these courts from clay to hard court. I am a 40 year resident of Brookline and have enjoyed many years of tennis at Amory.

Thank you,

Joe Hoffee

[Sent from Yahoo Mail for iPhone](#)

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From: [Diane Johnson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: ["adrienne h"](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts - Keep the Clay!
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 5:26:28 PM

Good afternoon, Jessie. I am sending this email on behalf of Adrienne Hoffman, who is copied on this note, and is a remarkable lady at 93. She has played at Amory over the last 9+ years and has organized/participated in several round robins and drop-ins for all age groups at the facility in addition to playing on a regular basis until putting her racket down at 91. She lives at 1111 Beacon Street here in Brookline.

Dear Jessie,

I moved to Brookline when I was 84, having played tennis both competitively on a national level in the 40s, 50s, and early 60s, and then as a teaching pro for 35 years. It was a miracle to me to discover public clay courts in an exquisite setting in my backyard. These courts are a treasure and made it possible for me to play until two years ago. In my day, there were very few injuries among the players – all the major tournaments were played on grass – unlike now when tournaments are played on a hard surface much of the time and players are riddled with injuries.

As one who lived in Baltimore for 83 years, I feel I am qualified to say as an “outsider” there is a most remarkable group of people who play at Amory – avid lovers of tennis, friendly, inclusive, from all over the world and country. Replace this treasure with hard courts and pickleball, and I fear you destroy a community.

Adrienne Hoffman

On behalf of Adrienne and me, thank you for your work on this project.

Cheers,

Diane

Diane M. Johnson
131 Freeman Street, 3A
Brookline, MA 02446
Phone: (617) 710-9016
Email: [REDACTED]

Serve boldly. Lead confidently. Keep up or you will become obsolete. You have values – don't compromise them.

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From: [Diane Johnson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts - Keep the Clay!
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 4:24:00 PM
Attachments: [Tennis Channel Comes to Amory.png](#)

Good afternoon, Jessie. I am writing because I am an avid tennis player and am excited about the renovation project for Amory. That said, I want to add my voice of support to keeping the clay courts at Amory in place.

When my husband and I moved to Brookline from Atlanta 24 years ago, we were delighted to find this beautiful tennis facility right in our backyard – it was even featured in a travel special on The Tennis Channel as a “hidden gem” (see photo), and we have played there every season since moving here. Unlike Atlanta where there are a large number of public hard and clay tennis courts available, this facility is special in Brookline as it is the only set of clay courts available to the public in the Town. Clay courts offer a different playing experience from hard courts, important for developing players; drain faster after a summer shower, meaning more access; and they are easier on the joints, allowing people to play well into their senior years; one of my hitting partners at Amory just put her racket down at 92! Hard courts are less forgiving, and I would speculate that many would simply stop using these courts if they were converted.

There are several hard court facilities throughout the Town that are available to the public (Waldstein, Florida Ruffin Ridley School, and Lawrence School come to mind) for those that enjoy playing on this surface. In addition, many of these offer pickleball lines/courts as well. If hard courts are added I am sure that there will be a push for adding pickleball lines/courts which would be an annoyance for the residents that surround Amory because of the sound. A quick search on Google, shows that, “frequent pickleball sounds are typically about **70 dBa** at about 100 feet away from the strike of the ball. Residents in homes located in a quiet residential area, that are within 100 feet from pickleball courts are used to noise levels of 40 dBa; therefore, the level of pickleball noise is 30 decibels louder.” Conflicts around this issue have made the evening news around the country.

Lastly, we all pay to play, and the cost of accessing these courts for the general public is much more affordable than joining a private club or driving miles to play. If fees/finances are a concern, I am sure there is a way to make this palatable for all.

Thanks for taking this project on. Please help us preserve this “hidden gem” in Brookline.

Best,

Diane

Diane M. Johnson
131 Freeman Street, 3A
Brookline, MA 02446
Phone: (617) 710-9016
Email: [REDACTED]

Serve boldly. Lead confidently. Keep up or you will become obsolete. You have values – don't compromise them.

From: [Kenneth Loveday](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory tennis courts
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 2:43:41 PM

To Jessie,

I have played at the Amory tennis courts for many years and support keeping them as clay courts. The current arrangement with a professional tennis group has worked well; the courts are well-maintained and are very active with lessons and all levels of play.

Sincerely,

Kenneth S. Loveday
127 Fuller Street

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From: [Kevin Shea](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 11:03:45 AM

Hello Ms Waisnor,

I am writing to express my strong support for maintaining the clay court surfaces at Amory Playground rather than converting the courts to hard surfaces. There already are plenty of hard court options in Brookline for tennis players.

Clay court surfaces offer a special experience for tennis players in Brookline. Clay courts are so much better for players over the age of 30 to enjoy the special experience of playing on clay courts. Clay courts allow time during a point for players to enjoy longer, more exciting rallies than hard courts and make the experience truly enjoyable.

Clay courts are also so much better for seniors - the courts are much more 'forgiving' and help to prevent injuries. Without clay courts, senior tennis participation will drop off dramatically, if not completely. Seniors who plan their day around a social afternoon of tennis and meeting with friends at Amory will sadly be left at home.

The clay courts at Amory have offered Brookline residents more than just a surface to hit tennis balls. They are a magnet for social interaction and camaraderie; so many friendships have formed over the years because Amory clay courts offer a special experience for Brookline tennis players.

They have been a cornerstone of the Brookline tennis culture for decades.

Please keep Amory tennis courts as Clay Courts!

Thank you for your time.
Kevin Shea

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From: [Phoebe Segal](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexander Bockman](#)
Subject: Amory Park CLAY tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 8:50:20 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

As residents of Brookline who frequently use the clay courts at Amory Park, we were dismayed to learn that the town is considering converting them to hard courts. Please, please do everything you can to preserve the beautiful clay courts for our community.

Sincerely yours,
Phoebe Segal and Alex Bockman
128 Sewall Ave, Apt. B
Brookline, MA 02446

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From: sandersen.harveyassoc.com
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Amory Tennis, Friends of](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 1:01:36 PM

Good morning Jessie,

It has come to my attention that there is a possibility the Amory tennis courts could be converted from clay to hard court. I would like to add my voice of strong objection to this short sighted idea. Brookline and Amory Park is a special place and a clay court adds to the classic atmosphere of the park which would be spoiled by a “parking lot” on such a beautiful spot. But there are many more reasons not to take this tact. There is a large middle age-senior group who play late into life on these courts because the clay surface is much easier on the body, we would surely lose that group of which I consider myself a member. There would inevitably be pressure to use the hard surface for other activities such as pickle ball which would add a good deal of noise to this residential area. There is also always the temptation of teens to use hard courts as a skate board venue. There is nothing intrinsically wrong with these activities but there are already appropriate facilities in the town for these, Amory is not one of them.

If financing is the overriding issue driving this idea, there are many creative ways to do that. We are paying fees to play and if these do not cover the costs many towns require the contracted party running the courts to cover the initial set up charge, I know that Newton does. Please consider other options than this idea.

Thank you,

Scott Andersen

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From: [Seth Kalvert](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 10:00:20 AM

Hello,

My understanding is that there is discussion by the Town to convert Amory courts to hard courts. Just writing to let you know that as a Brookline resident, I very much value the current clay/har-tru courts and would be very disappointed if they were paved over. The courts and surface are a real gem in the local tennis scene and provide something that few other areas can do. I know there are many considerations in all of these decisions but hopefully there are ways to solve for them without paving Amory.

Thank you,
Seth Kalvert
21 Fairmount St

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From: [Sophie Broderick](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Wendy Ames](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 7:34:00 AM

Good morning Jessie,

I am a 25 year homeowner in Brookline who has been playing tennis at Amory when I turned fifty, 12 years ago. It has come to my attention that there is a possibility the Amory tennis courts could be converted from clay to hard court. I would like to add my voice of strong opposition to this idea. Amory Park is a Brookline treasure and a clay court adds to the classic atmosphere and beauty of the park which would be spoiled by a "parking lot" on such a spot. As I'm sure you are aware, there is a large middle age-senior group who play late into life on these courts because the clay surface is much easier on the body, we would surely lose that group.

There would inevitably be pressure to use the hard surface for other activities such as pickle ball which would add a good deal of noise to this residential area. I am happy that the interest in pickleball has grown, getting more people active is good; but, we already have pickleball markings and players on all the hard courts in Brookline. We (tennis players) are not objecting to sharing those courts but conversion of the Amory courts will take away a cherished playing experience.

If financing is the overriding issue driving this idea, there are many creative ways to solve that rather than changing the playing surface at Amory.

Please consider other options than this idea.

Thank you,

Sophie Broderick
4 Vogel Terrace

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From: [Stephen Ullian](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory tennis courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 11:35:08 PM

Please no hardcourts and no pickleball at the amory tennis courts.
I am an abutter.

Sincerely, Stephen Ullian

1140 Beacon Street
Brookline, MA 02446

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From: [Ryan Davies](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts - support for clay courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 2:07:31 PM

Dear Jessie Waisnor,

I recently learned that Brookline is considering switching the Amory Tennis Courts from clay to a hard surface. I wouldn't normally get involved, but I would like to express how much of a loss this would be for the community. Tennis is a completely different game on clay courts. The slower speed of clay is much better for older players. There are no other public clay courts anywhere nearby. Longwood is prohibitively expensive to join. I am also worried that the usage of the courts will switch from tennis to pickleball, which is ***much*** noisier for the nearby residences. I understand that clay courts are more expensive to maintain, but the availability of clay courts is one of the reasons that Brookline is such an attractive and desirable place to live. Please do not take this away from the community.

Thank you,
Ryan

Ryan Davies
127 Jordan Rd., Brookline

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From: [Tom Johnson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Renovation Project
Date: Sunday, April 21, 2024 6:22:30 AM

Jessie,

While I am a representative of Friends of Amory Tennis, I am writing to express my own opinion and make some specific points that that we did not make as a group.

No surprise, I am a strong advocate for keeping Amory as clay. If my count is correct, we have 6 hard court facilities around Brookline - I am not sure why we should dismantle our crown jewel to add another one. I am confident that any push for converting Amory to hard courts is coming from people who want to have another option for pickleball courts because it is not coming from the tennis community. If the argument is that hard courts allow people to play year round, this is a questionable argument because I have driven by hard courts and they are simply not used in the winter - players that are committed to the sport as part of their exercise program access indoor facilities and the casual players just don't brave the weather. Also, Amory courts are nestled into a neighborhood (very different than, for example, the courts on Dean Road, Lawrence, etc.). Fights over the noise created by pickleball courts have made the evening news in Massachusetts and around the country. Bottom line, converting clay to hard courts would remove a valuable recreational opportunity for older people, it would not add additional usage because people just don't play outdoors in the winter months, and if what I suspect is behind any push for hard courts - a desire for another pickleball location - will create a firestorm with the neighborhood.

One final point, for anyone who may claim that "tennis is dead" - participation has never been higher in Brookline, which tracks national trends. During COVID, it was one of the few sports that was safe to play. 23.8 million play tennis in the US, up 35% in the past four years. [PowerPoint Presentation \(usta.com\)](#)

Thanks for all your hard work on this project.

All the best,

Tom Johnson, CAIA
Managing Director
Timberland investment Resources, LLC
1330 Beacon Street, Suite 311
Brookline, MA. 02446
www.tirlc.com
Office: [617-264-4769](tel:617-264-4769)
Cell: [617-320-9570](tel:617-320-9570)

"When you want to help people, you tell them the truth. When you want to help yourself, you tell them what they want to hear." Thomas Sowell

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From: [Bruce Levin](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis--Keep Clay
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:18:09 AM

I'd like to express how strongly my family, myself, and my neighbors feel about keeping the tennis courts at Amory as clay. The Town is fortunate to offer tennis players the option of having some clay courts available. Moreover, the courts at Amory are popular and almost always in use.

Additionally, the "slower" nature of clay makes the sport of tennis more accessible for beginners, older players, and those with tender knees or bad backs.

I'm also willing to bet that the clay courts are less harmful to the environment than most "hard courts," which are often made of acrylics, polyurethane, and other petroleum derivatives. The Amory courts are very close to the Hall's Pond Sanctuary and its many trees and plants. And clay courts make for a game that is significantly quieter than that played on hard courts. The neighbors should like that.

Please feel free to contact me if you'd like to discuss this further.

Very truly yours,

Bruce Levin, Town Meeting Member '17 and Recording Secretary of the Town Meeting Members Association.

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From: [Josko Silobrcic](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Appeal for keeping the clay tennis courts at Amory
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 8:37:35 PM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

My understanding is that the Town of Brookline may be considering converting the clay tennis courts at Amory to hard courts. As a longtime Brookline resident and avid tennis player, I am alarmed by this and am wholeheartedly joining the appeal that the clay court surface be preserved.

As a healthcare professional and older tennis player (in my 60s), I can confirm the many health advantages of the softer, clay surface. Moreover, having at least some clay courts in addition to the many hard courts already available in and around Brookline, significantly adds to the playing experience of tennis enthusiasts. As you know, Amory has a very devoted tennis player community, willing to support the upkeep of the clay courts through membership and other fees and such.

Please feel free to contact me should you have any questions.

Best,

Josko

Josko J. Silobrcic, MD, MPH, MS
42 Buckminster Road, Brookline, MA 02445
e-mail: [REDACTED]
phone: 781-929-6600

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From: [Fadette Berthold](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Armory Clay Courts - TO STAY
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:39:43 AM

Good morning,

I have been a longtime resident of Brookline and my family and I have played many..many times at Armory (if space is available due to the clay popularity) and my middle aged friends and I play and enjoy our time together there. Please don't strip away the few remaining joys for the aging population and for the young kids to be able to say that they played on clay!

Please...please...please...save the Armory's clay tennis courts.

Sincerely,

Fadette and family (4)

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From: [Alberto](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Armory Tennis
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:50:59 AM

Hi Jessie.

My name is Alberto and I am a senior who plays at the Armory tennis court.

I just learned that the Town of Brookline intends to convert the current clay courts into hard ones.

You may know that hard courts you need to run around much faster and, what is worse , they impose heavy stresses in foot and knee joints. For seniors like me and a lot others who currently play at Armory clay courts this could become a serious limitation in continuing with our tennis.

We are paying substantial real estate taxes and believe that we may have a small return on our tax burden by keeping the clay courts at Armory.

Please consider this plea and assume from the other senior (and surely younger ones) to maintain these clay courts at Armory.

Best regards
Alberto Orengo

Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Danil](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Armory tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 1:18:02 PM

Hello Jessie,

I became aware of the fact the Armory park courts may be converting into hard courts. I would like to voice my opinion that it would be great to keep those courts as is (CLAY) because:

1. no public clay courts available anywhere else in the close proximity
2. clay courts provide unique experience for players
3. clay courts are a lot healthier for the knees and joints than any other surface
4. clay courts allow the game even in a slight drizzle/rain conditions (unlike hard courts)

Thanks ,
Dan (Brookline resident)

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From: [Elaine Ullian](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: As the tennis courts are being contemplated..
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 11:22:38 AM

Good Morning.

I just wanted to reinforce my comments from the initial meeting regarding retaining the CLAY COURTS in Amory Park.

I thought there was an overwhelming collective agreement that CLAY would remain, however I have heard some faint requests for non clay. For all the reasons articulated at the meeting, including Amory being the only public CLAY option in Brookline, please please keep this as a key feature.

And PickleBall is a nonstarter as far as those of us who abut..truly abut..the tennis court area.

The sound pollution would be intolerable.

Every article written about the courts includes references to the substantial disruption and noise pollution that these courts bring with them.

I seriously doubt that there would be such a proliferation of them, had any parties anticipated how disturbing they are to residents in the vicinity of the courts.

I know we have an upcoming meeting on May 1st, but I wanted to be sure to convey my preferences and concerns early to you and the team.

Thank you in advance; see you at the upcoming meeting,

Elaine Ullian

1140 Beacon Street

617 459 1705

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From: [Eleanor Peters](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Brookline - Amory Playgound
Date: Saturday, April 13, 2024 4:24:48 PM

Hello Jessie,

I am a Brookline resident and a happy Pickleball player. I just heard about the Amory playground renovation project and wanted to chime in. I support a reconstruction of the clay courts to hard-surface courts.

Brookline is a fabulous community with a large, eager and growing Pickleball population. Brookline's Pickleball community is a very eclectic, diverse community of folks with a vast set of personalities. Doctors, repair techs, scientists, homemakers, 20 year olds, 80 year olds can't wait to meet again on the courts. It is the most inclusive sport that I've encountered.

One Hard-surfaced court, I'm sure this point has been made, can accommodate 8 pb players vs 2-4 tennis players. Usually there are 10-16 folks for one tennis court because we circle out after each game.

Brookline was way ahead of other towns in creating pb courts and offering exceptional clinics, lessons and group play. I hope the enthusiasm continues.

Thank you,
Eleanor Peters
20 Randolph Rd

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From: [Antonio Riccio](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Caly court at Amory
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 7:16:14 PM

Jessie,

I strongly support to have the clay court at Amory.

I am surprised that anyone from our tennis community would write in support of converting Amory to hard courts. If someone wants to play on hard courts, there are many other options in Town. It could likely be those that would like to see more pickle ball courts in town.

Please keep the clay court.

Thanks,
Antonio Riccio
phone: 617-820-3820

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From: [Suzanne Dean](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: clay
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 3:51:20 PM

Hello,
Please keep the clay courts.

Thank you,
Suzanne Dean

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From: [Ben Swanson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Clay courts at Amory
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 11:07:45 AM

Hello,

I'm a Brookline resident on Parkman st. My family and I love the Amory clay courts. This is something really unique for our neighborhood and I would love to see the renovation keep them. Hard courts are available all over town.

Thanks!

Ben Swanson
847-347-6743
Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Katie Bacon](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Clay courts at Amory
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 3:31:18 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I'm writing about the clay courts at Amory. I believe these clay courts are a valuable recreational resource for our town. As you know, they are the only semi-affordable clay courts available to people in the town. Clay is a much kinder surface for the body than hard courts, and many older people, and people in general, can only play on clay. Please do not turn these into hard courts! The clay courts at Amory are one of Brookline's most special recreational spots.

Best,

Katie Bacon

33 Fairmount St.
Brookline, MA

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From: [E.](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Clay Courts at Armory
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 1:12:25 PM

Hi,

As an avid tennis player I would like to make sure that our clay courts remain part of the community. This unique space is the catalyst of not just of a healthy physical activity, but of a broader community that convenes in this unique location. Please move away from any hard-court plan.

Best,
Eduardo

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From: [kathryn link](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Courts for tennis and pickle ball
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 7:30:43 AM

Hi,

I am writing in favor of a few things:

1. Please preserve and improve the clays courts for tennis only at Amory.
2. Please repair the hard courts at Lawrence for tennis only - the poor neighbors suffer from the noise of pickleball there as the surrounding buildings create very loud acoustics.
3. Please build dedicated pickleball courts in a park away from residences. I am a fan of any sport that gets people active and happy. I'm glad for the pickleball scene and want players to have nice courts made for their rules and away from the complaints of residences.

Thank you.

Kathryn Link
60 Harrison Street
Brookline 02446
3393680878

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From: [John Bowman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Fw: AMORY -- KEEP CLAY COURTS
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 10:43:00 AM

-----Forwarded Message-----

From: John Bowman [REDACTED]
Sent: Apr 23, 2024 9:59 AM
To: <jwaisor@brooklinema.gov>
Cc: <avecchio@brooklinema.gov>
Subject: AMORY -- KEEP CLAY COURTS

Dear Ms. Waisor:

I write to urge the Town to retain the clay tennis courts in conjunction with the rehabilitation of Amory Park.

By now, I am certain that you have heard in detail the benefits of the softer and slower surface for playing tennis on clay courts -- especially for older players like me -- so I will just say, "I agree." As a nearly five decades resident and taxpayer in Brookline, I took up tennis at Amory as a retirement sport -- good for exercise, for fun, for new challenges, and for making many new friends.

I add that more recently my wife (who is not a tennis player) and I have joined the BREC Pickleball program for senior citizens at Warren Field where we play outdoors one morning per week. I enjoy the sport, and I am pleased that the Town has painted the stripes for both tennis and Pickleball on its asphalt courts throughout the Town. But playing the game has also made me aware of the noise issue associated with Pickleball equipment. Noise, I think, is yet another reason why the Town should not replace the Amory clay courts with hard surfaces where the courts are so close to a large residential building and other homes.

Thank you for your consideration.

John E. Bowman, Jr.
10 Still Street
Brookline MA 02446

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From: [Monica Tovar](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Hard Surfaces for Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 6:47:25 PM

Dear Jessie,

I write to you from 1140 Beacon St. we are in unit 301 and just wanted to weigh in on the clay/hard court.

While we think it interesting to be proposing additional activities to Amory park (and we'd love to participate in future neighbor participation meetings that are on our calendar) we wanted to make sure we, as the closest neighbors request they not be changed, as the level of sound we believe we'd have would be significantly higher, especially for our neighbors on the lower side and park side of the building. If there is a neighborhood request for pickleball courts could one or two be located on the far end? Perhaps next to or replacing part of the existing parking? I believe that side does not abut with housing?

Thank you so much,
All the best,

Monica

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From: [Vargas, Sara](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: In favor of preserving the clay tennis courts at Amory Park
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:47:59 AM

Dear Jessie Waisnor:

I write in strong support of preserving the clay courts at Amory. I think of them as a town treasure. The older I get, the more I appreciate them. Now that I am in my 50s, many of my contemporaries (including my husband who has had two hip replacements) can no longer play tennis on hard surfaces.

Since pickleball can be set up in many different venues, such as existing hard tennis courts, basketball courts, and other paved surfaces, and it would seem a shame to sacrifice these treasured Amory clay courts for such a purpose.

If the Amory clay courts were removed then the availability of clay court tennis in town would be restricted to expensive/exclusive clubs such as The Country Club and Longwood Cricket Club or private individuals' homes.

Furthermore, destroying the clay courts would effectively demolish a wonderful collegial community of generally older-age tennis players that come together at Amory for the clay court experience.

Thank you for considering these points.

Sincerely,

Sara O. Vargas, M.D.
78 Stanton Road
Brookline, MA 02445



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From: [Beatriz Arias Garcia-Blanes](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory Clay Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:36:07 PM

Hi there,

My family enjoy playing at the Amory clay courts so much.

The clay courts are unique in the Brookline neighborhood and they are so pleasant to play in.

I ask that you please maintain these courts. There are so many hard court options in Brookline but only one clay. We also want to avoid the noise from pickle ball.

Many thanks,

Beatriz Arias

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From: [ignacio doblas](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory Clay Courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 4:13:20 PM

Hi,

My name is Ignacio and I enjoy playing with my family at the Amory clay courts so much.

As you know, the clay courts are unique in the Brookline neighborhood and they are so pleasant to play in.

I ask that you please reconsider maintain these courts. There are so many hard-court options in Brookline but only one clay.

Many thanks,
Get [Outlook for iOS](#)

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From: [Morris Efron](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory clay please
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 8:17:44 AM

Hi Jessie,

My wife and I are 60-something, 30-year residents of Brookline. In the last decade we've had the good fortune to take up tennis as one of our favorite forms of exercise, despite our mediocre level of play. What's made it possible is having a playing surface that our joints and backs can tolerate, namely clay. We cannot and do not play on any other surface. We are therefore deeply grateful to have access to the wonderful clay courts at Amory, where we play 3-4 times a week during the season.

We beg you to keep these Amory courts as they are - clay courts. I know we're not the only residents our age who need this forgiving surface to pursue the game. There are plenty of hard surface courts already around town that can be adapted to pickleball, but these are the only near clay courts we can use. Please preserve them.

With thanks,
Morris Efron
101 Coolidge Street
Brookline, MA 02446
617-549-7946

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From: [Eva L](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory Clay!
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 10:21:08 AM

Hello, please keep Amory courts clay, there are so few public courts that are clay, and many of us are grateful for the opportunity to play on clay. Thank you, and stay clay!

Eva Lundsager
Brookline resident

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From: [Julie Wingerter](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory Courts Clay
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 9:47:11 PM

Hi, Jessie,

It is my understanding that the town is considering making the Amory Courts a hard surface.

Please keep them clay- it's such a great option and brings in a wonderful crowd. They are used around the clock when open and feel like a real town asset.

I have also tried to play with my children at Columbia Park, and FRR-- all 4 courts are in terrible shape and feel less "nice" even if cleaned up.... Let's keep Brookline's amenities and add new ones, not take out the few amenities that we have (no outdoor swimming pool, no town ice skating rink inside, no investment in our one outdoor rink)....we really offer very little in public space options relative to our neighboring towns.

While we are at it, let's turf the field in front of the high school, too. The mud pit is ridiculous.

Julie

--

Julie Wingerter
15 Columbia St, Brookline, MA 02446

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From: [Adda Tewolde](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory tennis court clay court
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 8:44:36 AM

Good morning,

I am writing this email petition to advocate for the Amory tennis courts to remain clay. There are many courts in Brookline that are hard courts, and the one at Amory park happens to be the only clay court. For those of us who have weak knees and spines, the clay court offers a place to play tennis with less impact to the knees and backs!

I understand that the upkeep is more expensive but people also pay to play on these courts.

Thank you so much for all that you do!

Best wishes,

Adda Tewolde

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From: [Gloria Sutton](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep Amory's Tennis Court Clay surface
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 8:41:52 AM

Dear Jessie Waisnor,

I am writing to urge you and the Town of Brookline to keep the clay tennis court surface at Amory. Please do not lose this important resource by switching to a hard-court surface. While this may seem more efficient to maintain, hard court tennis will severely limit the ability of our town's senior and aging community to actively play. Clay allows those with less mobility to continue playing because the surface is softer on joints and slows the ball speed down requiring different ball handling skills.

Since 2013 when we moved to Brookline my family of four started playing tennis regularly at Amory Park. During the pandemic, the clay court tennis became the elixir of life providing a needed safe way to have fun! While I'll always play recreationally with my husband and two teenage girls, I joined the West Suburban Tennis League in 2021 have been playing league tennis regularly at Amory. We host matches with a range of teams from as far as Lancaster and Easton, MA as well as our neighboring towns of Newton and Wellesley. Amory's clay courts are the only public clay courts allowing Brookline to field teams and continue to participate in these tennis leagues against teams often fielded by private country clubs and racquet clubs. Amory keeps tennis public—open to all offering affording court time access and reasonable cost access to lessons and clinics. Tennis is a lingua franca, a language that unites and we see this in the teams we field and those that come each day to the court where you can hear Spanish, Portuguese, Haitian creole, and English spoken in a hundred different accents. Yet everyone is speaking the language of clay court tennis—serve, volley, sliding and cheering.

Every day I play at Amory, I see players from all areas of our town ranging in elementary school age right up through folks well into their 80s who are playing competitive matches. Seeing our senior teammates be able to maintain their level of competition because of the clay's forgiving surface is a priceless motivator for all of us who are now in our 50s and see tennis as the ticket to longevity and vitality. Clay court tennis is not just a recreational activity that has clear physical benefits—it is proven to improve one's social emotional life, increase mental acuity and provide a sense of community. These are all foundational elements necessary to thrive and the courts at Amory are a resource that serves all ages and all budgets. The Amory clay courts are inviting and bring folks together at a moment when most resources are seen as serving either / or segments—often pitting the planning of our town's resources against one another: youth vs seniors, fixed income vs. our town's well-off population. Clay court tennis at Amory which is affordable and open to all is a truly unifying resource.

Please maintain our clay court resource.

Gloria Sutton
95 Buckminster Road
Brookline MA 02445

From: [Beth Jones](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep clay at Amory
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 4:41:53 PM

Hello,

I understand that there is the possibility of paving the clay tennis courts at Amory Park and lining them for tennis and pickleball. There are so many reasons that this is a poor idea. Here are a few:

- They are among very few publicly accessible clay courts, rendering Brookline a destination for tennis players who will also spend money in other parts of the town.
- Clay provides a surface for people who are injured or elders to continue accessing exercise.
- You will be INUNDATED with noise complaints from high wealth neighbors who will surely be willing to litigate to decrease or remove pickleball from their neighborhood.
- it hasn't been proven whether or not pickleball is a trend that will decrease in participants in the not too distant future
- There are dozens of pickleball lined courts in Brookline already, and only one clay destination.
- Amory Park is in the middle of a densely populated area, more so than most of the tennis courts in town; you will undoubtedly find yourself tied up in Quality of Life lawsuits.

It is extremely nearsighted to remove the clay courts. They are an advertisement for Brookline as a town that sees the value of a diversity of recreational options. If you pave the courts at Amory, we become like every other town, and every other town where people complain about the noise of pickleball until residents camp out on the courts, deface them, and bring legal cases which render the pickleball courts unusable.

Yours, -Beth Jones, Griggs Road

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From: [Laura Alpert](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep the Amory tennis courts Har-Tru Clay!
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 10:04:12 AM

Dear Jessie,

I live and work in Brookline; in fact, my office is just a five-minute walk from the Amory tennis courts, where I play 2+ times per week during the summer. I understand that discussions are underway to change the courts from Har-Tru Clay to hard courts. I am firmly against this. Hard courts are a common surface that are hard on joints. They easily develop cracks, through which grass can grow, and require significant maintenance. Our Har-Tru Clay courts are special and worth preserving. Please consider and pass along my concerns. Thanks very much.

--



Laura Alpert
Chief Advancement Officer, MAB Community Services

[\(617\) 732-0241](#) | [\(518\) 464-4479](#)

[REDACTED]

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From: [Mary Kaufman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep the Clay courts at Amory
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 11:51:02 AM

Dear Jessie,

I heard from the Friends of Amory tennis that there is a discussion as to whether the Amory courts should be converted to hard courts vs clay.

I find it hard to believe that any active tennis player would be in favor of putting in hard courts over clay. There are dozens of hard courts available throughout the town, but Amory is unique in having a clay surface. At my age, I pretty much refuse to play on hard courts anymore due to the stress & strain on my joints. Clay is a much more forgiving surface. And I certainly would not pay for a membership at Amory or court time on hard courts. I urge you to keep this unique resource that Brookline has. It's so rare to have publicly available clay courts and if you look at the usage, they are in very high demand on weekends and evenings when working folks like to play, even at the additional cost when there are free hardcourts available elsewhere in town.

Best,
Mary Kaufman
109 Babcock St Brookline, MA

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From: [Jerry W](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Amory Tennis](#); [Amory Tennis, Friends of](#)
Subject: Keep the clay courts at Amory.
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 5:23:39 PM

Hi Jesse,

I am a 40 year resident of Brookline. I have had the pleasure of playing at the Amory courts for the past fifteen years. I am writing to register my very strong opposition to the proposed plan to convert the Amory clay courts to hard surface so that they can also serve as pickleball courts.

Playing on clay is a unique experience with benefits for players. Clay tennis courts can be more forgiving than hard courts, Clay is the slowest of the three main tennis court surfaces. Unlike the hard surface courts, it provides cushioning and reduces pressure on joints. This can help prevent injuries and allow players to train longer and play more without pain. Clay also slows down the ball which can help players more easily develop their skills and increases reaction times , a benefit to older players. Many of the players who "hit" at Amory are there because it's easier on our joints, extending our playing sessions and our years of tennis activity. And, we pay fees for the extra maintenance that the clay surface requires to provide that experience.

I am happy that the interest in pickleball has grown, getting more people active is good; but, we already have pickleball markings and players on all our hard courts in Brookline. We (tennis players) are not objecting to sharing those courts but conversion of the Amory courts will take away a cherished playing experience and will decrease the playing days for many of us.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best Regards,

Jerry Wolosenko

71 Perry Street, Brookline

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From: [Marjorie Whittaker](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Keep the clay!
Date: Thursday, April 18, 2024 3:00:31 PM

Dear Jessie,

Dear Jessie:

I am writing to express, in the strongest possible terms, my family's desire to keep the Amory courts a clay surface. We are a large and dedicated tennis community, and we have numerous compelling reasons to ask that you keep the surface clay, or consider installing an advanced hybrid surface which would be easier and more cost effective to maintain.

The pickleball community in the town is enthusiastic about converting Amory to pickleball-lined hard courts. Although I play pickleball as well as tennis, I vehemently disagree with this plan. We can play at Baker, Longwood, Waldstein and Warren, and many private residents have made their own courts on their property. Pickleball is noisy, and I am sure the residents in the densely populated area of Amory would have a problem with the annoying noise. As a matter of fact, at the dedicated pickleball courts in Mashpee on the cape, ONE SINGLE HOMEOWNER was able to shutter the courts due to the noise. If this happened at Amory, the tennis players as well as the pickleball players would have no place to play.

Clay tennis courts and hard courts offer distinct playing experiences due to their differing surface characteristics. Here are some reasons why some players might find clay courts easier or more favorable compared to hard courts:

Slower Ball Speed: Clay surfaces slow down the ball more than hard courts. This gives players extra time to reach the ball and set up their shots. This is beneficial to skill development, as well for players to improve their game tactics.

Reduced Impact on the Body: Clay is a softer surface compared to the rigidity of hard courts. This softness helps in absorbing some of the impact, potentially reducing the strain on players' joints and muscles. This makes it particularly appealing for players, as it decreases the chance of injuries and lessens the wear and tear on their bodies. This is particularly true for seniors and those with arthritis or other orthopedic challenges. There are players at Amory who are into their 80's and even 90's who foster a cross generational community, which benefits everyone in town.

Skill Development: Playing on clay can help develop a player's patience, strategy, and overall skill set. The need to construct points carefully and adapt to slower game dynamics can enhance a player's versatility and understanding of the game.

I have long been happy to pay a fee to the town to maintain the clay, but will not pay to have a hard court surface at Amory.

Having beautiful clay courts is special, and adds so much to the allure of this town, as does Lars Anderson Park and Skating Rink and Putterham Golf Course. These special and unique facilities contribute to Brookline's appeal, and benefit all of the residents who live in Brookline. Their property values are reflected in amenities such as the clay courts at Amory.

Re: pickleball in general. I believe it would be great if the town invested in dedicated pickleball courts, in a location with parking, and without neighbors on all sides. For example, Skyline Park comes to mind. If a fee were suggested to build and maintain those facilities, I believe the large and growing pickleball community would be open to that. Pickleball players have lots of options, as mentioned above, but there is only ONE clay court in town that can accommodate those who can only enjoy the sport on a softer surface.

Thank you so much for considering keeping Amory, the treasure, as it is.

From: [Alina ROYTBURG](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Deborah Cohen](#)
Subject: Objection to hard courts in Amory Park
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 2:42:41 AM

*Hello, Ms Waisnor,
I am a long term resident of 1140 Beacon street and
I would like to express my opposition to possible conversion of hard courts and pickleball out back.
My sense of the noise level generated by this sport as it will be closest to our building and my neighbors
at 1140 Beacon Street. If Amory is converted to a hard court/pickleball facility, I think it would be quite
annoying to have it so close to our apartment building. A quick search on Google, shows that, "frequent
pickleball sounds are typically about **70 dBa** at about 100 feet away from the strike of the ball.
This is a quiet residential area with noise levels of 40 dBa, therefore the level of pickleball noise is 30
decibels louder.
It will also be continuous and impact the park.*

Thank you for your attention

Alina Roytberg

Sent from my iPhone

Le contenu de ce message peut etre protege et / ou confidentiel. Si vous avez recu ou
avez des raisons de croire que vous avez recu ce message par erreur, s'il vous plait,
supprimez le sans le lire et avisez immediatement l'expediteur.
The contents of this message may be privileged and/or confidential. If you have received
or have reason to believe you have been sent this email in error, please delete it
without reading it and notify the sender immediately.
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From: [Kathleen Cohen](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Allan Cohen](#)
Subject: Oppose hard courts and pickleball at Amory Park
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 10:34:19 PM

We feel that the noise levels would interfere with the quality of life for surrounding residents. As residents of 1140 Beacon Street, we appreciate your consideration of this fact in your planning process.

Sincerely, Kathleen and Allan Cohen #103

Sent from my iPad

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From: [Jeffrey Tiger](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Please keep Amory courts clay
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 5:16:30 PM

Hello Ms. Waisnor,

I am writing to express my support for keeping Amory courts clay. I have been a Brookline resident and a user of the Amory courts since 2013.

The opportunity to play on quality public clay courts in the Amory Park setting is a real gem of Brookline, and I always look forward for the courts to open. Clay allows for play, lessons, and local youth sports to continue despite intermittent light rains, which are common in this area. Clay is also easier on joints than hard courts, and I have heard multiple players say they only play on Amory's courts. I have been willing to pay a nominal fee to support the courts as a seasonal "member" or as a per-use charge, and would gladly continue that in order to help pay for its upkeep. Finally, I have enjoyed the camaraderie of the group that routinely plays here.

Please support keeping Amory's courts clay.

Sincerely,

Jeff Tiger

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From: [REDACTED]
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Please keep Amory tennis courts as clay courts=
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 10:33:49 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I am a resident at 1140 Beacon Street. I am writing to voice my strong preference for keeping the Amory tennis court as clay courts.

I am a regular tennis player and have played on both clay and hard courts. Clay is noticeably friendlier on my joints. As a tennis player, I value how much more forgiving clay is on my body. Amory Court being the only clay courts open to the public in the greater Brookline area, it would be a great loss for the community to have it converted to hard courts.

As a resident of 1140 Beacon Street with a unit that faces the tennis courts, I am also anxious about the amount of noise that 6 hard courts will generate.

Thank you for your attention. I sincerely hope my opinion will be noted.

Regards,
Ellentina Admadjaja

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From: [N Ni](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Please keep Amory's Clay Courts!!
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:43:33 AM

Dear Jessie,

As a Brookline resident and season-passholder at Amory tennis center, I am writing to urge you to please help Brookline keep Amory Park's clay tennis courts.

The clay courts are a special feature of the area, and give Brookline something special for residents and non-residents to enjoy. Having clay tennis courts sets us apart from other towns that do not have such. People from other towns and even other states hear about Brookline's clay courts and seek to visit to see for themselves and experience playing on them. Amory Park and Brookline would not be as special or notable without the clay courts. Conversion to hard courts would make the space feel like another Waldstein or even the back of a school - it would do the neighboring Halls Pond a great injustice. Halls Pond, the field, and the clay courts together, as a trifecta, bring a relaxed and elegant feel to the area.

In sum, the clay courts are a defining feature of Brookline - please let's not sell ourselves short, let's keep a long-term vision for the area. The clay courts align well with Olmstead's influence on the natural landscape of the area as well (Emerald Necklace, Muddy River).

If you would like additional feedback or have any questions, please let me know!

Best regards,
Nancy Ni

Sent from my iPhone

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From: [Beatriz Doblas](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Please keep the Amory clay courts!
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:27:28 PM

Hi there,

My name is Bea Doblas and I live in Brookline. The best part of my life in Brookline is playing on the Amory clay courts. They are the only clay courts around and it's truly spectacular and special as a tennis fan to play on clay. You can find hard courts anywhere but not clay. It really is a unique experience.

These clay courts really elevate Brookline and they are a source of great joy for our Brookline community. They also make tennis more accessible for my older friends who cannot play on hard courts.

I ask that you please help us keep the clay courts, it's essential to keep the uniqueness of this neighborhood.

Many thanks,
Bea Doblas
857 272 3301

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From: [Buks Moolman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Please keep the Amory Park clay courts. I am In favor of preserving the clay tennis courts.
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 3:58:50 PM

Dear Jessie Waisnor:

Please keep the clay courts. We have been residents in Brookline over 20 years, and over the years have played on the clay courts. It is such different experience compared to hard courts.

I have had two hip replacements and cannot play on hard courts. Clay is easier on the body. It is the only public clay courts we have in Brookline. Please consider preserving them.

Sincerely,

Buks Moolman
78 Stanton Road
Brookline, MA, 02445

Assistant Professor of Practice of Accounting - Merrimack College

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From: [Amy Harwin](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#); [Select Board](#)
Subject: Please keep the Clay Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 11:59:12 AM

Hi Jessie-

I am writing to ask the City to keep the clay courts!! It is amazing to have the opportunity to play on those for regular town use. Those of us who play on them love it and appreciate the variety the town has to offer. A lot of us play tennis AND pickleball so we use them all. There are also a plethora of hard courts, not only at the parks like Dean/Waldstein but also the courts at the schools and Eliot St. as well.

Thank you for your help and support!
Amy Harwin

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From: [Thomas R. Marton](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Preserve the clay tennis courts at Amory Park
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:13:47 PM

Ms. Waisnor –

I am a long-time (30+ years) resident of Brookline, a recent Town Meeting member, and I consider the publicly-available clay courts at Amory Park a most precious and special resource (as does my entire family, who have grown up with it).

I am a regular season member, and during the season play tennis there as often as I can. There is really no other place like it. The clay surface, which is not readily found elsewhere (indeed, as a public amenity, I am not sure it can be found elsewhere), is especially important, sometimes critical even, for those of us north of 40 years old or for anyone wanting so much to keep playing tennis, but concerned about the impact of a harder surface and the added wear and tear on knees, hips, backs, and other joints. And because of its uniqueness and importance, it has fostered a great, and greatly invested, community of players who especially care about this particular treasure.

For all these reasons, I here register my earnest view that the Town should make every effort to preserve these clay courts as clay courts, and their available status as a public resource.

Whatever you can do to help in this effort is most appreciated.

With thanks for your consideration and efforts and, more generally, for your service to our Town,

Tom Marton
32 Russell St.
Pct 9.

Thomas R. Marton, Esq.

Lourie & Cutler, P.C. ~ 60 State Street, Boston, MA 02109 ~ P (617) 742-6720 ~ F (617) 848-5821

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From: [John Shreffler](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Fran Perler](#); [Alexandra Vecchio](#); [Ann Frechette](#)
Subject: Re: Amory DRC updated comment
Date: Monday, April 8, 2024 11:45:25 AM

Jesse,

Hi! I'm John Shreffler, Co-President of Friends of Hall's Pond and I'm seconding what Fran said about preserving the quiet space for Hall's Pond and Amory Woods. As Conservation Sanctuaries, these properties exist for preservation of habitat and have very severe restrictions on public use. Essentially only passive recreation and that being restricted to the paths.

friendsofhallspond.org



This is from our website but these rules are from the Town Conservation Commission. It's important to emphasize this during the Hall's Pond part of the project as the public has a very hard time distinguishing Hall's Pond and Amory Woods from the adjacent Amory Playground which is open to the full gamut of active and passive recreational activities.

Looking forward to the process as the opening session went really well. I've sat in on one Design Review Committee and a couple of Master Plan projects and the team here is as good as I've seen

John

John Shreffler
Co-President Friends of Hall's Pond
60 Browne Street Apt. 6
Brookline MA 02446
(857) 218-0822 (cell)
(617) 232-0466 (home: goes to voicemail)

On Mar 21, 2024, at 3:25 PM, Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov> wrote:

Hi Fran,

Nice to meet you virtually as well. I will add your email to the DRC packet that will be distributed before the next meeting and your email will also be shared with the design team. Thank you for passing along this information and your participation on the committee.

Have a great weekend!

Jessie Waisnor | PLA | CPSI
Senior Landscape Architect
Brookline Department of Public Works | Parks and Open Space Division

333 Washington Street 4th Floor | Brookline, MA 02445
Office: 617-730-2616 Cell: 781-249-2278
Home Office: M&Th 7:30-4:30 and F 7:30-12 Town Hall Office: Tu&W 8-5

-----Original Message-----

From: Fran Perler [REDACTED], 2024 3:22 PM
To: Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov>
Cc: Alexandra Vecchio <avecchio@brooklinema.gov>; John Shreffler
<>; Ann Frechette <>=Subject:
[REDACTED]

Hi Jessie,

Good meeting yesterday.

I spoke with the heads of the FoHP Board and they agree with the following, which we would like to be added to the DRC record and sent to the consultants.

The non-boardwalk trails in the Hall's Pond Sanctuary do need an upgrade, but it is important to keep them rustic. Hall's Pond is a WILDLIFE Sanctuary, not a park. Increasing people on the upper trails would be detrimental to migrating and nesting birds if all the folks who use the boardwalk continue onto the upper trails. As a birder, I often see birds frightened away from feeding by the continuous flow of people on the boardwalk. Tom Brady has commented that Hall's Pond is one of the most visited wildlife sanctuaries in the state. We need to keep a quiet area or the birds will loose and stop taking advantage of Hall's Pond. Then we loose.

Thank you for considering this.

Take care,
Fran Perler
Precinct 8 TMM
Council on Aging, Citizen Member
Friends of Hall Pond, Board Member

.....
Sent from Fran's iPad. Language errors courtesy of autocorrect.

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From: [Tom Johnson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#); [Jeffrey Nutting](#); [REDACTED]
Subject: Re: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Wednesday, April 17, 2024 6:11:50 AM
Attachments: [image002.png](#)
[image003.png](#)
[image004.png](#)

Thanks Jessie. We will reach out to the community to get them engaged. We appreciate all your work on this project.

All the best,

Tom Johnson, CAIA
Managing Director
Timberland investment Resources, LLC
1330 Beacon Street, Suite 311
Brookline, MA. 02446
www.tirlc.com
Office: [617-264-4769](tel:617-264-4769)
Cell: [617-320-9570](tel:617-320-9570)

“When you want to help people, you tell them the truth. When you want to help yourself, you tell them what they want to hear.” Thomas Sowell

On Apr 16, 2024, at 5:26 PM, Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov> wrote:

Hi Tom,

I was sent your email below as the project manager for the Amory Playground Renovation project. First thank you for your email it will be shared with our design consultant team and the design review committee. To answer your question about the surfacing the consultant team has been asked to present options for keeping the courts' clay and for changing them to a hardcourt surface. They were asked to do this as we have received letters of support for both surfaces. There have been no decisions made to date and we anticipate this information being presented at the next design review committee meeting on Wednesday, May 1st. I would encourage people to attend the public meetings to provide their comments or if they are unable to do so please email me so they can be shared with the committee and team. If emails for comments could be emailed to me by Wednesday, April 24th so they can be included in the information packet we send to the committee members before the meeting that would be greatly appreciated. The final decision for the type of surfacing will be voted on by the design review committee and then the full Park and Recreation Commission.

Any other questions or comments please reach out.

Thank you,

Jessie Waisnor | PLA | CPSI

Senior Landscape Architect

Brookline Department of Public Works | Parks and Open Space Division

333 Washington Street 4th Floor | Brookline, MA 02445

Office: 617-730-2616 Cell: 781-249-2278

Home Office: M&Th 7:30-4:30 and F 7:30-12 Town Hall Office: Tu&W 8-5

[<image002.png>](#)

[<image003.png>](#)

[<image004.png>](#)

[<image005.jpg>](#)

From: Alexandra Vecchio <avecchio@brooklinema.gov>

Sent: Tuesday, April 16, 2024 3:37 PM

To: Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov>

Subject: FW: Amory Tennis Courts

F [REDACTED]

Sent: Tuesday, April 16, 2024 5:37 AM

To: Jessica Potter [REDACTED]

Cc: Alexandra Vecchio <avecchio@brooklinema.gov>; Erin Chute

<echute@brooklinema.gov>; [REDACTED]
recreation@town.brookline.ma.us; Jeffrey Nutting <jnutting@brooklinema.gov>

Subject: Amory Tennis Courts

Jessie,

I am writing you on behalf of the tennis community, and especially the supporters of Friends of Amory Tennis. We are of course excited about the project that is underway to redesign and improve the tennis facilities at Amory. We were first informed of this project in 2018 when we began meeting with the Town. One of the concerns of the tennis community is maintaining the clay courts at Amory. I know when pursuing a project of this nature, it is easy – and arguably prudent – to consider alternatives, like hardcourts. The argument would be that the facility could be used year-round and with a dual purpose – tennis and pickleball. However, there are significant advantages to clay courts which include:

1. Clay courts dry much faster than hard courts, allowing play within a few hours after a rain event, so there is greater use during the height of outdoor tennis season;
2. Clay courts at Amory generate revenue for the vendor and therefore for the

- Town (both directly in fees for play as well as indirectly by enabling the vendor to relocate fee generating camps there post rain) – hardcourts would eliminate those revenues and therefore reduce payments to the Town that vendors would propose when bidding for the concession (all else being equal);
3. Amory fields already have a drainage problem, which would presumably be exacerbated by hardcourt runoff;
 4. Clay is much easier on the joints and body, enabling older players to continue the sport and all players to play more frequently with lower risk of injury. ***These are the only clay courts in Town;***
 5. Amory abuts closely to neighbors – the sound of pickleball play would be untenable; this cannot be overstated, as it is the single most common complaint about pickleball nationwide. There are several other hard-court facilities in Town that are already set up and in use for both.

The issue is that we regularly get rumblings that converting Amory to hard courts is being considered. If that is not the case, we encourage you to make that clear to the community. On the other hand, if that a consideration, we would appreciate knowing so we can get the tennis community mobilized. This topic is very important to hundreds of people in the tennis community, and we want to work constructively, as I believe we have been, with the Town but we also don't want to be caught by surprise.

Cordially,

Tom Johnson, CAIA
Managing Partner, Client and Corporate Development
Timberland Investment Resources, LLC
1330 Beacon Street, Suite 311
Brookline, MA. 02446
www.tirlc.com
Office: 617-264-4769
Cell: 617-320-9570
<image006.gif>

"When you want to help people, you tell them the truth. When you want to help yourself, you tell them what they want to hear." Thomas Sowell

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From: [Martin Lipman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#); [friends-of-amory-tennis](#)
Subject: Re: Friends of Amory Tennis - Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 10:48:03 AM

Dear Jessie,

Like so many others, I just wanted to add my voice and strong endorsement for the town to maintain the clay tennis courts at Amory park. My wife and I moved to Brookline about 5 years ago. I agree with all the points made by my fellow friends of Amory tennis. Accordingly, there is no need for me to repeat them here. One related point I would add is that while there is an excellent, world class tennis facility (Longwood Club), located in Brookline, for a myriad of reasons, the great majority of Brookline residents do not have access to that facility. Providing the amenity of clay tennis courts to Brookline residents is one of the reasons Brookline is so special. To lose that amenity would be heartbreaking to so many of us.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Marty Lipman
227 Summit Ave.
Brookline, MA 02446

On 04/19/2024 5:15 PM EDT David Haarmeyer [REDACTED]

Dear Jessie,

I am writing to strongly object to any proposal to convert Amory clay tennis courts to a hard surface. I have been fortunate to have played at the Amory courts for the over 28 years that I have lived in the community. It's not an exaggeration to say that without Amory clay courts my tennis years would have been over years earlier given that I have had a bad (ACL-torn) knee. I am 66 years old and would appreciate the opportunity to continue to play tennis as long as I can.

Amory's clay courts and Amory park together make up one of Brookline's special gems that the town should embrace and treasure. There is an abundance of hard courts, but public clay courts are extremely rare.

Any challenges related to the courts' maintenance and finance should be openly discussed. There is a strong and growing Amory tennis community that is capable and willing to step up and assist the town where and when needed.

Please let me know if you have any questions.

Kind regards,

David Haarmeyer
1569 Beacon Street, No. 54
617 877 5338

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To send mail to this group, use:

LIST MEMBERS:, please respect that this is an open community forum for everyone involved with Amory tennis.

You received this message because you are subscribed to the Google Groups "Friends of Amory Tennis"= group.

To unsubscribe from this group and stop receiving emails from it, send an email to friends-of-amory-tennis+unsubscribe@googlegroups.com.

To view this discussion on the web visit https://groups.google.com/d/msgid/friends-of-amory-tennis/CAMbdYs1NoRZ1pFdnext%2BjgX%3Dkx_aWbtmSnR9meLH8Kw%3Dr7Fz%2Bng%40mail.gmail.com.

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From: [Henry Rath](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Re: Keep Amory's Tennis Court Clay surface
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:02:05 AM

Dear Jessie,

My wife recently sent you a note, and I am writing to second it. She and I play at Amory as much as we can, and even though we live much closer to the hard courts at Waldstein, we much prefer the clay surface at Amory and we don't have access to any other clay courts. Please keep the clay - it is a key differentiator in Brookline rec and one that is very important to the community.

Kind regards

Henry Rath

95 Buckminster Rd

On Mon, Apr 22, 2024 at 8:41 AM Gloria Sutton [REDACTED] wrote:

Dear Jessie Waisnor,

I am writing to urge you and the Town of Brookline to keep the clay tennis court surface at Amory. Please do not lose this important resource by switching to a hard-court surface. While this may seem more efficient to maintain, hard court tennis will severely limit the ability of our town's senior and aging community to actively play. Clay allows those with less mobility to continue playing because the surface is softer on joints and slows the ball speed down requiring different ball handling skills.

Since 2013 when we moved to Brookline my family of four started playing tennis regularly at Amory Park. During the pandemic, the clay court tennis became the elixir of life providing a needed safe way to have fun! While I'll always play recreationally with my husband and two teenage girls, I joined the West Suburban Tennis League in 2021 have been playing league tennis regularly at Amory. We host matches with a range of teams from as far as Lancaster and Easton, MA as well as our neighboring towns of Newton and Wellesley. Amory's clay courts are the only public clay courts allowing Brookline to field teams and continue to participate in these tennis leagues against teams often fielded by private country clubs and racquet clubs. Amory keeps tennis public—open to all offering affording court time access and reasonable cost access to lessons and clinics. Tennis is a lingua franca, a language that unites and we see this in the teams we field and those that come each day to the court where you can hear Spanish, Portuguese, Haitian creole, and English spoken in a hundred different accents. Yet everyone is speaking the language of clay court tennis—serve, volley, sliding and cheering.

Every day I play at Amory, I see players from all areas of our town ranging in elementary school age right up through folks well into their 80s who are playing competitive matches. Seeing our senior teammates be able to maintain their level of competition because of the clay's forgiving surface is a priceless motivator for all of us who are now in our 50s and see tennis as the ticket to longevity and vitality. Clay court tennis is not just a recreational

activity that has clear physical benefits--it is proven to improve one's social emotional life, increase mental acuity and provide a sense of community. These are all foundational elements necessary to thrive and the courts at Amory are a resource that serves all ages and all budgets. The Amory clay courts are inviting and bring folks together at a moment when most resources are seen as serving either / or segments—often pitting the planning of our town's resources against one another: youth vs seniors, fixed income vs. our town's well-off population. Clay court tennis at Amory which is affordable and open to all is a truly unifying resource.

Please maintain our clay court resource.

Gloria Sutton

95 Buckminster Road

Brookline MA 02445



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From: [Sergio Modigliani](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Modigliani Suzanne](#); [Erin Chute](#); [Alexandra Vecchio](#)
Subject: Re: Why Amory Tennis Courts Should Remain Clay
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 2:46:18 PM

Ms. Waisnor:

I'd like to expand on my wife's comments below and request these be made a part of the public record, but you, as a Landscape Architect, are undoubtedly already well aware of the matters I list below, so I write to the decision-makers as well:

Background:

A. The Amory Playground area, as is well-known by all in Town, is an area subject to flooding, due both to its filled location above what was a portion of the Muddy River system (part of which is now in a brick culvert that flows down Amory to the Charles), and a very low elevation in relation to the local floodplain level in the area.

B. The courts are surrounded on the south, west and east by a mix of multi-story residential and single family homes, at a distance which for some units is under 60' (sixty feet).

In such conditions:

1. Adding more paved and impermeable surface would likely require new storm water management at added first cost, while the existing clay courts absorb and dissipate water. Like the Hall's Pond area adjacent, the courts function like a sponge to absorb and control rain events.
2. It is well documented that paved tennis courts generate more noise than clay courts, thereby adding to noise impacting the surrounding residences.
3. Clay courts are recognized as reducing physical impacts on player's legs and joints, especially knees. compared to hard courts.
4. Clay courts are recognized as becoming playable more quickly after rain events than paved surfaces.
5. Clay courts are recognized as reducing heat island effects in urban settings, an ever increasing issue with climate change, and especially where, as here, they are part of an existing green zone important to the area.
6. Paved tennis courts have recently become the favored site of Pickleball Courts. Now, multiple municipalities have enacted constraints on Pickleball due to noise - and some have banned them outright in public locations. This location must not allow Pickle ball.

These are some examples why we believe **Parks and Open Space should take affirmative action to ensure the Amory Courts remain clay.**

Please let me know of any questions,

Thank you,

Sergio Modigliani, Architect=
1160 Beacon Street, Unit #101=
T: 617.823.3384
[REDACTED]

On Apr 23, 2024, at 1:58 PM, Suzanne Modigliani
[REDACTED]

Hello

We live at 1160 Beacon St. on the first floor and are direct abutters to the Amory=
courts, a true asset to our community.

We are very concerned about the possibility of the conversion to hard courts=
where the sound is much greater. And the potential of pickleball noise would be=
unacceptable, to say the least.

I recognize the maintenance of clay courts is more expensive. But that's part of=
why they are a treasure.

Sincerely,

Suzanne and Sergio Modigliani

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From: [Dawn Effron](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Request to Maintain Clay Courts at Amory
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:03:27 AM

Hi Jessie,

I have been a resident of Brookline for over 30 years, and in the past decade, my husband and I have come to enjoy playing tennis at Amory Park as a great form of exercise suitable for our 60s. Most of us who play there are unable to use hard courts due to bone and joint issues that often accompany aging.

We are deeply grateful for access to Amory's excellent clay courts, where we play several times a week during the tennis season. Many residents our age depend on these gentler surfaces to continue playing tennis. Although there are many hard courts in town that could be adapted for uses like pickleball, the clay courts at Amory are uniquely valuable and irreplaceable to us.

Please preserve the clay courts!

Thank you for considering our request.

Dawn Effron
101 Coolidge Street
Brookline, MA 02446
(857) 225 2564

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From: [Ross Yellin](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Request to Maintain Clay Surface for Amory Park Tennis Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 11:07:20 AM

Dear Miss Waisnor,

I hope this letter finds you well. I am writing to express my strong support for maintaining the clay courts at Amory Park. As you may know, these courts are not only a community treasure but also provide significant benefits that are integral to their continued popularity and functionality.

The clay surface at Amory Park is crucial for many reasons. Foremost, it is significantly easier on the body compared to hard surfaces. This is particularly important for our community's older tennis players, who prefer clay due to its ability to reduce the strain on joints and decrease the risk of injury. For many, the clay courts at Amory are the only viable option for continuing their beloved sport into their senior years.

Moreover, the clay courts foster a vibrant sense of community. Personally, these courts have been instrumental in introducing me to many wonderful people in our neighborhood, enriching my experience, and creating lasting bonds. The atmosphere around the clay courts is one of camaraderie and inclusion, which is invaluable, especially in this day and age.

Many community members have expressed a strong preference for playing exclusively at Amory Park rather than on other town-provided hard courts. Changing the surface from clay to a hard one would not only alter the physical experience but could also disrupt this community fabric, potentially deterring a significant number of players from continuing to use the facility.

I urge you to consider these points carefully. Maintaining the clay courts at Amory Park is essential for accommodating the physical needs of our aging population and preserving a cherished gathering spot that enhances our community's quality of life.

Thank you for your attention to this matter. I trust you will make a decision that best supports the health, well-being, and unity of our community.

Warm regards,
Ross Yellin

Ross Yellin
1217 Beacon Street #1, Brookline, MA 02446

617.501.0503 Mobile

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From: [Matthew Abrams](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Request to Preserve Clay Tennis Courts in Brookline at Amory Park
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:09:41 AM

Dear Jessie Waisnor,

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to express my concern regarding the potential conversion of the Amory Park clay tennis courts in our community to hard (asphalt) courts. As an avid tennis player and a resident of Brookline, I believe that preserving our clay courts is essential for maintaining the unique character and charm of our town's recreational facilities.

Clay courts offer several advantages that make them preferred by many tennis enthusiasts. They are easier on the joints, provide a slower pace that encourages longer rallies and strategic play, and are generally more forgiving for players of all skill levels. Additionally, clay courts have been a staple of our community's tennis culture for years, attracting players from near and far to enjoy the sport in a setting that feels natural and inviting.

Converting these beloved clay courts to hard courts would not only alienate many of our current players but also detract from the overall appeal and diversity of our tennis facilities. While hard courts have their merits, they do not offer the same experience or benefits as clay courts, and their introduction could lead to a decline in participation and interest in tennis within our community.

I kindly urge you to reconsider the decision to convert the clay tennis courts to hard courts and instead invest in maintaining and improving our existing facilities. By doing so, we can continue to foster a love for tennis among residents and visitors alike while preserving the unique character that makes Brookline such a special place to live and play.

Thank you for taking the time to consider my request. I look forward to hearing your thoughts on this matter and hope that we can work together to find a solution that benefits everyone in our community.

Warm regards,

Matthew Abrams
13 Craig Pl
Brookline, MA 02446

203-241-9509

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From: [Megan M](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Save Amory clay courts
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 8:15:03 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I understand that there is a proposal to resurface the clay tennis courts at Amory Park and turn them into hard courts. I was shocked to hear about this since Amory is such a valuable resource in our community.

I believe this would be a huge waste of resources and a major loss to the community. I have been playing tennis at Amory for several years and have developed many intergenerational friendships as a result. The courts are a great resource for residents of all ages. Clay courts are better for older (and all) players because they reduce the risk of injury. Also, it is very difficult to access clay courts in Boston if one is not a member of an exclusive (and expensive) club. Amory is a rare gem that equalizes access to tennis in Brookline.

Instead of spending MORE money to resurface the courts at Amory, why not make an effort to publicize and make the most of the clay courts at Amory? I would be happy to join a committee focused on brainstorming ways to get more revenue out of the Amory courts, if that is an issue of concern.

There are several other hard courts around Brookline that could be converted to pickleball courts. For example, why not convert the courts at Warren field to pickleball? These courts are underutilized relative to other courts and the cost of conversion would be far lower than the cost of resurfacing Amory.

Best wishes,
Megan MacGarvie
21 Addington Rd.
617-899-0628

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From: [Ana](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Support for clay courts at Amory
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 6:28:52 PM

Dear Jessie,

My name is Ana Balcarcel and I am a user of the Amory clay courts all the time, so I am sending an appeal to PLEASE KEEP THE COURTS. Clay tennis courts are less stressful on the joints of the lower body and back and thus allow players to train longer, play for more years and have less pain and fewer injuries. This is beneficial to our senior tennis players and people like me that have joint problems. There are plenty of public courts that are already lined for pickleball (a sport that (unlike tennis) is a new sport that is growing but has little history and it is not clear it is here to stay). When making this decision, Brookline needs to consider all of the pros and cons and the fact that there are no public clay courts. The Amory Park is a very special park. Please keep the courts as they are.

As a Brookline resident and user of the Amory courts, please carefully consider my appeal to not make any change to the Amory tennis courts.

Thank you,

Ana Balcarcel

149 Beaconsfield Rd

Brookline, MA 02445

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From: [Patty Levi](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Support for Clay Courts at Amory
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 3:31:17 PM

Dear Jessie,

I am a user of these courts all the time, so I am sending a BIG appeal to keep the courts clay. I am aware that others have shared the means by which to keep the cost of clay lower by using new materials. These courts were highlighted in a magazine as being SPECIAL to the town of Brookline. There are at least 14 public courts or more in the town that are already lined for pickleball. When making this decision, Brookline needs to consider the noise that is present with pickleball. The Amory Park is a very special park and would hate to see it changed in any way, especially the clay tennis courts.

As a resident and user of the Amory courts, please carefully consider my appeal to not make any change to the Amory tennis courts.

Most sincerely
Patricia Levi
22 Chestnut Place, 401
Brookline, MA 02445

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From: [Michael Caplan](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Tennis at Amory Court
Date: Tuesday, April 23, 2024 7:48:43 PM

Hi Jessie,

My name is Michael Caplan.

I'm a 65 year old resident of Brookline.

My wife and I raised two boys who attended Brookline High School. My older son played on the BHS tennis team. I grew up here, graduated BHS in 1976, and returned here after college and medical school.

I also played on the BHS tennis team. I love the game. Unfortunately, hard court tennis has done a job on my knees. My orthopedist advised me to play my tennis on clay courts only because the "sliding stop" is easier on the knees.

The Amory clay courts are such a wonderful amenity for Brookline residents. If you take them away, I'll have to pay to play on courts outside of town.

Brookline is full of older people. Clay court tennis is much easier on the knees. Newton has clay courts. Why would pave over ours?

This is short-sighted on the part of the people overseeing the Amory renovation.

There are lots of hard courts but only Amory has clay. Please do not take them away from those of us who play at Amory, making "sliding stops" on clay, and enjoying this fun, healthy activity.

Thank you for your consideration,

Respectfully,

Michael Caplan MD
BHS '76

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From: [sheera hefter](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Tennis courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 6:19:20 PM

Hi Jessie

I'm a near lifelong resident of Brookline and heard just this morning that there is a real risk that the courts at Amory may be turned into from clay to hardcourt. I'm reaching out to ask you to please reconsider and move ahead with the original plan to simply renovate the current courts/fence etc. As some of the only (the only?) public clay tennis courts in the area, the Amory center is a gem, and a treasure! My kids started playing there on the softer surface and it was fantastic. My dad has met an incredible group of people who are part of the community there and plays there regularly. Personally, as a tennis player first, there are so few places left in town for us to play. I often have to go to Brighton or Mattapan or Roxbury to play tennis and pickleball has taken over many of the local courts. I enjoy pickleball, but it feels like tennis is getting pushed out or prioritized in an inequitable way.

I sincerely wish this wasn't a panic moment, but indeed that is what it feels like. I would be very very interested to learn more about how and why this sudden possible change is being considered. It would be a real misstep for the town to deviate from the necessary planned renovations in a way that would negatively affect an entire community.

Unfortunately I can't attend the Wednesday meeting, but would be interested to learn how I can keep up to date on developments and opportunities for conversation and discussion.

With appreciation,
Sheera Hefter
Brookline Resident

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From: [Helen Herman](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Tennis courts at Amory
Date: Sunday, April 21, 2024 9:00:52 PM

Sent from my iPhone

Hi Jesse,

I am not a tennis player but I live on Beacon Street and the courts are behind my house.

I am concerned about our increasing rainfall and wonder which will absorb more water and produce less flooding onto the road between our house and the courts, clay or concrete. The road already gets a good amount of water and we would appreciate any work that improves the situation rather than worsens it.

Thank you for your consideration.

Helen Herman

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From: [Kristie Gill](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Tennis Courts at Amory
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:47:41 AM

Hello -

I am a Brookline resident and recently took up tennis. The courts at Amory are a major reason that I embraced the sport. Our town is so fortunate to have 6 clay courts. I would be crushed to see them taken away and changed to hard court. I use them with a large group of friends several times a week during the season. I love the community and the multi-age experience of the weekend morning round robins. The access is amazing. It is very important to me that those clay courts are part of the future planning of Amory park. Thank you.

Best -
Kristie Gill
4 Auburn Court

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From: [Diane Souvaine](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: the status of Brookline
Date: Friday, April 19, 2024 11:05:18 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

Brookline has an amazing reputation as a city that offers numerous cultural activities for residents of all ages and that endorses healthy aging. Coolidge Corner, Washington Square, and Brookline Village, together with two branches of the library are treasures. And the Brookline Senior Center contributes greatly to the lives of our seniors. As does the Amory tennis complex. I purchased my condo in Washington Square in 2021 based on all that Brookline has to offer to all of its residents and yet also to its seniors.

One may not think of tennis as the sport of seniors, and yet when one has clay courts, it is. If you come out on a Saturday or Sunday morning to the open Brookline round robin at Amory, over 50 percent of the folk are over 65, for example, and includes folk who are well into their 80s. From a personal perspective, the one time that I played pickleball (on a hard court), I fell and broke my collarbone. [Perhaps I am one of the statistics reported here: <https://www.prnewswire.com/news-releases/new-study-identifies-increased-fracture-risk-for-older-pickleball-players-302058911.html>]. And yet I play tennis regularly, with enjoyment and without injury.

The orthopedists are clear: elders can continue to play tennis throughout our lives if and only if we play on soft courts. Consequently, the Amory Tennis Center is an invaluable asset to the people of Brookline of all ages and should be preserved. Please don't do anything to take that away from us. If for some reason, the maintenance costs are just too great, artificial clay like ClayTech or else the new Hybrid Clay could be considered, but please maintain Amory as a clay (of some form or another) facility.

Thank you for your consideration,
Diane Souvaine

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From: [Christine Altieri](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Courts
Date: Monday, April 22, 2024 9:15:01 AM

Good Morning Jessie -

My name is Christine Kane, 139 Davis Ave and I am concerned to hear that the town is thinking about turning the beautiful clay courts at Amory to hard courts - There are SO many hard court in the town, and plenty of places to play pickleball = I think we can find better uses for our tax dollars like keeping our teachers and providing assistance to our schools

I hope that the town will not take away one of the assets of this town

Regards,
Christine

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From: [Erin Fleming](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 7:49:45 AM

Dear Jessie,

I have been a patron of the Amory Tennis Courts for many years and I desperately need to play on clay due to the herniated discs in my back and my ACL surgery. I am still in my 30s but I can no longer play on hard courts due to the many injuries sustained from the constant pounding on hard courts. I hope you reconsider converting the clay courts to hard.

Furthermore, clay courts are playable in the rain and given all the rain Boston has each summer, clay is absolutely necessary. Net results can continue with their scheduled programming despite the rain.

I would be absolutely devastated if you convert the Amory courts to hard courts. I need the soft surface now more than ever.

Thank you for your consideration.

Sincerely,

Erin Fleming

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From: [Thomas Loring](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park Tennis Courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 8:11:59 AM

Ladies and Gentlemen:

I am writing to express thoughts on the proposed idea of converting the Amory Park tennis courts from clay to hard courts and possibly converting some to pickleball. As a 70+ player who has enjoyed playing at Amory for several decades, I strongly support retaining all the clay courts.

Unfortunately clay tennis courts are a diminishing public recreational resource everywhere. Amory is unique not only in Brookline but in the greater Boston area providing clay tennis courts available to everyone without having to join a private club. Playing on soft clay courts is not only enjoyable but forgiving on body joints as opposed to hard courts that are stressful on and deteriorate knees and hips.

Pickleball courts are much louder than tennis courts due the ball struck (~70 dBa at 100 feet) by the hard paddle versus strings of a racket . These courts should be located in a non residential site to mitigate against the louder and to some people disturbing 'whack' of the ball. Amory with residences directly adjacent to the courts is unsuitable for a pickleball location.

I strongly support retaining all the clay courts at Amory Park.

Thank you,
Tom

Thomas Loring


<https://www.thomasloring.com>
617-756-4724

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From: [Kara Weiss](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Please preserve the clay courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 9:35:47 AM

Dear Jessie,

I'm writing in strong support of preserving the clay tennis courts at Amory. As a Coolidge Corner resident, I rely on the clay courts as the only playing surface that doesn't destroy my knees! I'm only 41, but a lifetime of sports has taken its toll! Please keep the clay courts!

Best,

Kara Weiss
50 Naples Road

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From: [Kathleen McKenna](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Playground/Courts Renovation
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 7:07:55 AM

Good morning Ms Waisnor:

I understand you are overseeing the renovation project at Amory Park.

I would like to add my voice to the discussion about turning the clay tennis courts into hard courts in order to keep maintenance costs down.

Here's why I hope the town decides to keep the Amory courts clay:

-There are lots of free (public) hard courts already in Brookline. Many of them are empty during high tennis season, while Amory (public, but costs \$\$ to play) is always busy.

-Clay is easier on the aging body. For two seasons my regular partner was a 90-year-old woman. Her tennis life was extended thanks to those courts. Take a look at the players who meet in the morning at Amory. These are regulars who play 3-4 times a week. And many are older than I am. I am 67 now and the clay surface will extend my tennis life too.

-Amory is a gem in the Boston area. Not many communities offer clay courts open to the public. I would hate to see the clay covered over by concrete just to save some money.

I know I am so lucky to have these courts nearby. I can walk there — meet up with friends — play some tennis — and watch some tennis too. And still be able to walk home because my knees don't hurt!

Thank you for taking the time to read my email.

Kathleen McKenna
43 Columbia St #B
Brookline 02446

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From: [Sowmya and Dave](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Clay Court
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 5:02:51 PM

I would love to keep the Amory clay courts. There are many hard courts around Brookline but these are the only clay courts and I hope the town doesn't convert them.

Thanks

Sowmya

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Jessie Waisnor

Parks and Open Space Division
Town of Brookline
333 Washington Street
Brookline, MA 02445

April 24, 2024

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I'm writing to you with my thoughts regarding the Amory Park project. I live in Brookline and have family that lives very close to the park, and am a frequent visitor in all kinds of weather.

I've heard that there is a question about whether the existing clay tennis courts should be replaced with hardcourts, and whether there should be pickleball lines added to the courts. From my reading of the Brookline Recreation website (and some googling), the town has 30 tennis courts throughout its parks and schools; Amory comprises six of those courts. It appears that all of the town's other tennis courts are hardcourts. I understand that there are proponents on either side for clay courts or hardcourts, and my suggestion is that there be further investigation of how the town's tennis courts are utilized, and what the level of demand is for clay courts and hardcourts, before a decision is made for the Amory courts. It seems problematic to replace the town's only clay courts with hardcourts, based on support letters from a fraction of the town's residents. I would wholeheartedly support keeping the Amory courts as clay courts, but would also like to hear more from others. Also, if there are maintenance considerations that would also impact the decision about the court surface, it would be helpful to know what those considerations are, as well as the the amount of any financial or cost implications. Having all of this information will help the town and residents to make a fully informed and carefully considered decision.

I would also note that hardcourts will likely result in more noise, and it would be helpful to understand the potential noise impacts of both hardcourts and pickleball courts, preferably from an analysis done by an acoustical consultant. If the town did end up adding pickleball lines to the courts, there should be rules about using equipment that minimizes noise for adjacent neighbors.

I reviewed the slide deck from the March 20 public meeting, and noted multiple mentions of mature trees. It was difficult to tell from the slides what was observed or proposed about the park's trees, but I concur that the park has a number of mature trees and that they are a distinctive feature of the park, visually and as a way to provide shade. I did not see mention of a tree health assessment by a third-party arborist, but I hope that such an assessment will be completed for this project (this is a standard practice for capital projects at UC Berkeley, where I'm the director of the campus planning office). Such an assessment would give us a definitive understanding of the trees' overall health, how much longer they will last, and whether any tree succession planning needs to be conducted as part of this project. It would also be helpful

to know if any of the existing park trees are susceptible to climate change impacts, and if they should be replaced by different tree species over time.

I also have a few comments about stormwater runoff at the park. First, there is stormwater runoff entering the southern edge of Hall's Pond from the adjacent private parking lots, and this runoff is carrying gasoline and/or other hazardous substances from the parking lots into the pond and its surrounding area. I have frequently seen an oily sheen on shallow standing water on the pond's surrounding grounds after it has rained, and I have also seen ducks eating plants growing in these areas. This would appear to be an unacceptable environmental impact that needs to be mitigated. Second, the playing field tends to be wet and muddy after significant rains. Understanding that regrading the field or installing a drainage system under the field may be financially infeasible and out of scope for the project, if the surrounding landscape improvements can include stormwater detention and retention facilities such as bioswales, that would improve overall stormwater runoff mitigation for the entire park. Stormwater treatment facilities would also be welcome.

Thank you--

A handwritten signature in purple ink, appearing to read 'Marissa Cheng', with a large, stylized loop at the end.

Marissa Cheng

Brookline resident
45 Longwood Ave, Apt 507
Brookline, MA 02446

From: [Dan Nguyen](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Park tennis courts: Please keep the clay
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 9:27:04 PM

Hi Jessie,

I hope this email finds you well. I'm writing to add my support towards keeping the Amory Park tennis courts as clay. I played Division I tennis at Harvard, and have been involved in the tennis community in the greater Boston area for over 10 years.

I remember first learning about the Amory courts and simply being amazed that there were quality clay courts available to the general public. It is something that is usually only found at private (and expensive) tennis clubs. It truly is special that a city/community can provide accessible & affordable clay courts to its residents, reinforcing the unique character of Brookline. I say this after seeing a vast array of tennis facilities/parks throughout the country during my junior, high school, & college tennis experiences; the Amory clay courts are truly a gem.

As a Brookline resident, I love seeing the Amory courts filled with players of all ages and hope the clay continues its incredible service to the community for years to come.

Thank you so much Jessie for your time and efforts.

Best wishes,
Dan Nguyen

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From: [Kathleen McKenna](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Playground/Courts Renovation
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 7:07:55 AM

Good morning Ms Waisnor:

I understand you are overseeing the renovation project at Amory Park.

I would like to add my voice to the discussion about turning the clay tennis courts into hard courts in order to keep maintenance costs down.

Here's why I hope the town decides to keep the Amory courts clay:

-There are lots of free (public) hard courts already in Brookline. Many of them are empty during high tennis season, while Amory (public, but costs \$\$ to play) is always busy.

-Clay is easier on the aging body. For two seasons my regular partner was a 90-year-old woman. Her tennis life was extended thanks to those courts. Take a look at the players who meet in the morning at Amory. These are regulars who play 3-4 times a week. And many are older than I am. I am 67 now and the clay surface will extend my tennis life too.

-Amory is a gem in the Boston area. Not many communities offer clay courts open to the public. I would hate to see the clay covered over by concrete just to save some money.

I know I am so lucky to have these courts nearby. I can walk there — meet up with friends — play some tennis — and watch some tennis too. And still be able to walk home because my knees don't hurt!

Thank you for taking the time to read my email.

Kathleen McKenna
43 Columbia St #B
Brookline 02446

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From: [Daniel Ory](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 10:26:38 AM

Dear Jessie,

I am writing to you regarding the proposed redesign project for the Amory Courts. As a member and user of the Amory Courts for a number of years, I can attest to the unique public resource that the courts provide to both as a former Brookline resident and currently a non-Brookline resident. There is no equivalent facility in greater Boston available to the public, whereas there are many options with regard to hard courts for tennis or pickleball. By maintaining the clay, the town supports a diverse and vibrant community. Please do not pave over the clay!

Dan Ory
347 Commonwealth Ave
Boston, MA 02115

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From: [Werner Lohe](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 11:57:05 AM

Dear Ms. Waisnor,

I am writing to you in my personal capacity and as a Town Meeting member in Brookline, although wearing several hats, I have had some experience over the years with the facilities at Amory Park.

I understand that consideration is being given to replacing the clay in the Amory tennis courts with asphalt. Although at first blush the negative environmental impact of roughly an acre of tennis courts may not seem significant, there is such an impact—even including climate-change impacts, particularly heat-island effect. I won't detail other impacts since I'm sure you're well aware of them.

I hope the clay courts can be restored rather than replaced based on a more "global," if you will, concern. We face multiple existential environmental and social crises. Recreation spaces are critical supporting the social leg of the three-legged stool of sustainability, but how we maintain those spaces is also important. And it's not just the big decisions made far away that count, but also every little decision each of us makes that will determine what the world looks like fifty years from now. In every decision we make, we need to step back from extractive technologies and our habitual waste of resources. Does it matter that I tell my kids, "Turn off the darn lights when you leave the room." I hope so. There are big bills of various sorts that the Town pays and will pay to maintain these courts for our residents. In the design decisions you're making, what is the equivalent of turning off the lights?

Sincerely,

Werner Lohe

^^
Werner Lohe
TMM, Pct. 13
25 Salisbury Road
Brookline, MA 02445
617-739-0892 (home)
^^

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From: [Michael Brower](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Amory tennis courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 10:16:13 PM

Dear Jessie,

I've become aware through the grapevine that there's a possibility the Amory Park tennis courts will be removed or paved with a hard surface. I hope this isn't the case, and I ask you to preserve the Har-Tru surface if possible. If any public hearings are planned, or if public opinion is being solicited formally, please let me know. I would be happy to provide comment.

Kind regards,

Michael Brower
Tennis Player
978-835-8263
1258 Beacon St, Apt 1
Brookline MA 02446

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From: [Robert Jaye](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Clay courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 1:55:21 PM

Amory tennis centre is a treasure. Please know as a Brookline taxpayer I am for the clay courts. Asphalt is also bad for the environment since it does not absorb water and increases run off. Yes keep the clay.

Regards
Robert

Robert Jaye
26 Monmouth Court #2
Brookline MA
02446
c (617) 462-4954


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From: [Marissa Cheng](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Comment letter regarding Amory Park project
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 2:34:54 PM
Attachments: [Amory Park letter 2024-04-24.pdf](#)

Hi Ms. Waisnor,

I am a Brookline resident and had some comments on the Amory Park project -- please see the attached letter. Feel free to get in touch with me with any questions about my letter.

Thanks--
Marissa Cheng

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Jessie Waisnor

Parks and Open Space Division
Town of Brookline
333 Washington Street
Brookline, MA 02445

April 24, 2024

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I've heard that there is a question about whether the existing clay tennis courts should be replaced with hardcourts, and whether there should be pickleball lines added to the courts. From my reading of the Brookline Recreation website (and some googling), the town has 30 tennis courts throughout its parks and schools; Amory comprises six of those courts. It appears that all of the town's other tennis courts are hardcourts. I understand that there are proponents on either side for clay courts or hardcourts, and my suggestion is that there be further investigation of how the town's tennis courts are utilized, and what the level of demand is for clay courts and hardcourts, before a decision is made for the Amory courts. It seems problematic to replace the town's only clay courts with hardcourts, based on support letters from a fraction of the town's residents. I would wholeheartedly support keeping the Amory courts as clay courts, but would also like to hear more from others. Also, if there are maintenance considerations that would also impact the decision about the court surface, it would be helpful to know what those considerations are, as well as the the amount of any financial or cost implications. Having all of this information will help the town and residents to make a fully informed and carefully considered decision.

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Thank you--

A handwritten signature in purple ink, appearing to read 'Marissa Cheng', with a large, stylized loop at the end.

Marissa Cheng

Brookline resident
45 Longwood Ave, Apt 507
Brookline, MA 02446

From: [Rob Schoen](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#); [Alexandra Vecchio](#)
Subject: Community letter supporting conversion of Amory Tennis Courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 7:03:46 PM
Attachments: [Amory Courts Letter Supporting Conversion.pdf](#)

Hello,

In advance of the May 1st Zoom meeting, I would like to submit a letter that has been signed by 42 Brookline residents, supporting the conversion of the Amory Street Tennis Courts to multi-use, year-round hard courts. A scanned copy with the signatures is attached. If you need the hard copy, please let me know where I can drop it off. We may try to collect more signatures in the final week, and if we do I will send them over.

Thank you for your work on this project!

Rob Schoen
10 Beech Road
617 447-8496
www.longwoodmall.org

Members of Brookline's Pickleball Community would like to express our strong support for the possible conversion of the clay tennis courts at Amory Street Park into multi-use hard courts. This transformation could serve as an opportunity to embrace the growing enthusiasm for pickleball in our community, help address our public health priorities, and enhance the social fabric of Brookline.

Pickleball's soaring popularity in Brookline is undeniable, with sessions organized by Brookline Recreation consistently reaching full capacity shortly after availability. The current infrastructure, however, does not meet the community's demands, leaving many residents with insufficient opportunity to engage in this invigorating and accessible sport.

The benefits of converting the existing clay tennis courts to multi-use hard courts extend beyond accommodating more pickleball players. Such a conversion is an investment in the community's health, social well-being, and inclusivity:

- Promoting Physical Activity: Pickleball offers a fun and engaging way for individuals of all ages to maintain an active lifestyle. Its accessibility encourages regular participation, contributing to the overall health and wellness of our community members.*
- Fostering Community and Combatting Loneliness: In a time when many are seeking ways to rebuild social connections, pickleball stands out as a sport that naturally fosters community spirit. The inclusive and welcoming nature of the pickleball community in Brookline promotes social interaction, forming lasting friendships and combatting feelings of isolation.*
- Inclusive to All Ages: Pickleball's appeal across a wide age range, especially among seniors, is noteworthy. For older community members, the sport offers not just physical activity but also valuable social interaction, addressing significant health risks like isolation and sedentary lifestyles.*

Petition:

Re: Converting Amory's Clay Courts to Multi-Use Hard Courts

Members of Brookline's Pickleball Community would like to express our strong support for the possible conversion of the clay tennis courts at Amory Street Park into multi-use hard courts. This transformation could serve as an opportunity to embrace the growing enthusiasm for pickleball in our community, help address our public health priorities, and enhance the social fabric of Brookline.

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- *Inclusive to All Ages: Pickleball's appeal across a wide age range, especially among seniors, is noteworthy. For older community members, the sport offers not just physical activity but also valuable social interaction, addressing significant health risks like isolation and sedentary lifestyles.*
- *Maximizing Facility Utilization: Converting to multi-use hard courts significantly increases the capacity for recreational activities. A single tennis court can accommodate two pickleball courts, effectively quadrupling the participation rate for the same spatial footprint. This*

efficient use of space maximizes community benefits, ensuring more residents can enjoy recreational activities.

- Year-Round Accessibility: Unlike the seasonal clay courts, hard courts offer year-round usability, similar to the ones at Waldstein and Warren parks. This transition not only increases the courts' availability throughout the year but also ensures that our community's investment in recreational infrastructure delivers maximum value and accessibility, regardless of the season.

By supporting the conversion of the Amory Street Park clay tennis courts to multi-use hard courts, the Parks and Recreation Department will demonstrate a commitment to promoting an active, inclusive, and socially connected community. We respectfully urge you to consider this proposal, not only as a response to the growing demand for pickleball facilities but as a proactive measure to enhance the quality of life for all Brookline residents.

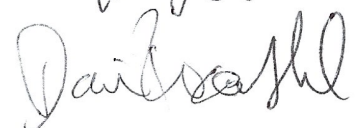
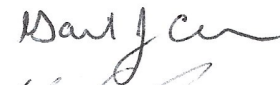
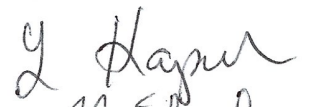
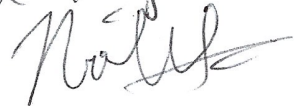
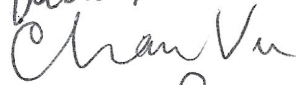
Rob Schoen
10 Beech Road
617 447-8496
longwoodmall.org

<u>Signature</u>	<u>Print Name</u>	<u>Brookline Address</u>
Robert Matuson	Robert Matuson	75 Beacomfield Rd
Ronald Matuson	Ronald Matuson	75 Beacomfield Rd
Steven Leduzinski	Steven Leduzinski	197 Gardner Rd.
C A Dupre	Claudia J. Dupre	1731 Beacon St. # 1109
Allyson Appen	Allyson Appen	20 John St Brookline MA 02246
Deborah McBry	Deborah McBry	21 Babcock St #1
Marsha Zierk	Marsha Zierk	244 Summit Ave.
Martin Fishkin	Martin Fishkin	49 Ackers Ave
Suki Freeman	Suki Freeman	256 Summit Ave
Jay Lee	Jay Lee	105 Browne
Barbara Lee	Barbara Lee	105 Browne

Signature

Print Name

Brookline Address

	Jeanne Rintel	161 Wollcott Rd
	Jack Rossin	26 John St
	DAVID ROSENTHAL	249 Dean Rd
	Susan Konnit	35 Park St
	John Miranda	60 Beverly Rd.
	Eleanor Biers	20 Randolph Rd
	Gail Corcoran	54 Ackers Ave
	Hannah Elbaum	1 Winchester St
	Jeff Corruthers	30 Stearns Rd #501
	Lorna Kapte	38 Devon Rd.
	Nirban Singh	25 Englewood Ave
	MATTHEW KAPUSTA	38 DEVED RD
	Rochelle Borg	75 Winchester
	KYLA HERBLUM	75 Winchester St
	SUSAN HUNT	43 Salisbury Rd
	Aaron Federman	38 Juniper St
	Chau Vu	38 Juniper St
	Sally Rosenthal	249 Dean Rd.

SignaturePrint NameBrookline Address

Paige L. Wilson

PAIGE WILLIAMS

47 CUMBERLAND AVE

Michael Hughes

MICHAEL HUGHES

47 Cumberland Ave

Deborah Gaudes

Deborah Gaudes

135 Clark Rd

Jacqueline M. Corcoran

Jacqueline Corcoran

43 Wolcott Road

Paul Landesman

Paul Landesman

44A Harvard Ave #3

Michael Wojcik

Michael Wojcik

39 Beals St

Jane Wojcik

Jane Wojcik

39 Beals St

Robert Husson

Robert Husson

13 Searle Ave

Corey Donovan

Corey Donovan

100 Tappan St

MARTIN WILSON

MARTIN WILSON

2377 FOSTER AVE

Barbara Way L

Barbara Way L

75 Windester St

- *Maximizing Facility Utilization: Converting to multi-use hard courts significantly increases the capacity for recreational activities. A single tennis court can accommodate two pickleball courts, effectively quadrupling the participation rate for the same spatial footprint. This efficient use of space maximizes community benefits, ensuring more residents can enjoy recreational activities.*

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From: [Ridker, Paul M.,MD, MPH](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 11:56:58 AM

Jessie,

I am a long time tennis player in Brookline, a physician dedicated to preventive medicine, and I am seeking information on the proposed changes to Amory Park. In particular I am seeking reassurance that whatever is done that the soft har-true courts are preserved. As I am certain you are aware, these are the only soft courts in town and thus a gem for the tennis community, particularly for those of us with older knees!

I can be reached at 617-759-0716 if useful to you.

Best,

Paul Ridker

Sent from my iPhone

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<https://www.massgeneralbrigham.org/complianceline>

<<https://www.massgeneralbrigham.org/complianceline>> .

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From: [Sara Sarkhili](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Preserve Amory Park's Clay Tennis Court!
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 4:47:41 PM

Dear Jessie,

I am writing to express my strong opposition to the proposed conversion of the Amory Park clay tennis court into a hard court. Clay courts offer a unique playing experience and provide several advantages for our community, as outlined below:

- **Versatility:** Clay courts are suitable for a wider range of skill levels, from beginners who appreciate the slower ball speed and easier rallies to experienced players who enjoy the challenge of strategic play. Hard courts, with their faster pace, can be intimidating for newcomers.
- **Physical Benefits:** The softer surface of clay courts reduces stress on joints, making them a safer option for players of all ages, especially those prone to injuries.
- **Improved Technique:** Clay courts encourage players to develop better technique and footwork due to the need to slide and generate power from the surface.
- **Weather Resistance:** Clay courts drain well and can be played on soon after rain showers, unlike hard courts which can become slippery.
- **Community Value:** Clay courts offer a distinctive playing experience not readily available elsewhere in our area. Their presence attracts players from neighboring towns, fostering a sense of community and promoting local businesses.

A thriving Amory Park clay court can be a valuable asset for our town. It caters to a diverse group of players, encourages healthy exercise, and fosters a vibrant tennis community.

Before making a final decision, I urge you to consider exploring alternative solutions, such as:

- Investigating upgrades or maintenance to extend the lifespan of the clay court.
- Offering instructional programs for beginners and intermediate players to increase utilization of the clay court.

Thank you for considering my concerns. I would be happy to discuss this further and work together to preserve this valuable resource for our community.

Sincerely,

Sara Sarkhili

Verndale Street, Brookline, MA

From: [elizabeth.maheras](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: resurfacing the Amory tennis courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 4:44:38 PM

Dear Jessie,

I am writing in complete opposition to the resurfacing of the clay tennis courts at Amory park. PUBLIC clay tennis courts are few and far between. Having clay tennis courts for everyone in our town benefits many such as juniors who are playing USTA tournaments (some are on clay) and may not have access to private clay courts; older players (I'm 60 and have been told to stick to clay to hopefully prolong a knee replacement); those that want something cooler during the heat of the summer; and those that want a more rounded game - you play differently on clay.

If one of the reasons why you/they want to replace the clay with a hard surface is for pickleball, you/they are short sighted. Pickleball courts are popping up everywhere indoors and out and it is most likely a trend that is going to wane. Also, Pickle can be set up anywhere quickly and easily - basketball courts, driveways, even on grass. I have a friend that plays it on her backyard clay tennis court and easily switches from tennis to pickle! Maybe that could be done on Amory's clay tennis courts?

Whenever I play tennis at Amory, I am reminded of what a great community our town has with people of all ages and abilities playing and chatting on the side of the court. On a hot summer day people prefer to play on clay at Amory.

Clay tennis is also part of Amory's uniqueness. Please, don't make it like any other park.

Sincerely,
Liz Maheras

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From: [Ruth Nemzoff](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: The Amory tennis courts
Date: Wednesday, April 24, 2024 8:53:09 PM

Thank you for soliciting the opinions of neighbors before paving over the tennis courts. Although I am not a tennis player, I know that Clay courts are the gold standard so for that reason alone, I would hope you would keep them. In addition I know that they are less noisy than blacktop courts.

My biggest concern is that I won't want anything to affect the absolute gem we have in the Amory Park i.e. the Halls Pond RESERVATION , so if noise or water impermeability of the courts would have any danger of changing that sanctuary, I would beg you to avoid the blacktop court."

Thank you for your efforts.
Please share with the others on your committee.
Ruth Nemzoff 1160 Beacon St. Brookline, MA 02446

Ruth Nemzoff, Ed.D. www.ruthnemzoff.com
Resident Scholar, Brandeis Women's Studies Research Center, Epstein 079. [515 South St. Waltham, MA 02454](#)
Author and Speaker: [*Don't Bite Your Tongue: How to Foster Rewarding Relationships with Your Adult Children*](#), [*Don't Roll Your Eyes: Making In-Laws Into Family*](#)
Recent talk: ["What We've Learned About Jewish Grandparenting in Interfaith Families"](#)

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From: [Brad Lucas](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Date: Thursday, March 21, 2024 11:19:54 AM

Hi Jessie,

It was a pleasure to “virtually” meet you, your Brookline Parks and Open Spaces colleagues and the architectural team on last night’s kick-off Zoom meeting for the Amory restoration project. It was a helpful introduction, and impressive to see the expertise around the design and project table. I was glad that I got to participate and appreciated the opportunity to share some of my concerns.

As I mentioned last night, my wife and I live at 1140 Beacon Street, and our unit overlooks the tennis courts. Our dog is always a happy recipient of an errant tennis ball or two that end up on our balcony during the season. Needless to say, I don’t think there’s anyone that lives closer to the park than we do.

In fact, it was the view of the park that was such an important draw when we decided to buy our unit nearly 20 years ago when the building was being developed. In the early years, our view was unobstructed. Unfortunately, when the wind screen was attached to the fence, we lost a good part of our view of the park’s open spaces. We’d hate to see any further decline. I understand that there are quite a number of options for fabrics/textiles, transparency levels, etc. for the screens and kindly ask that there be some thoughtful and creative thinking done by the design team when considering what screens and fencing styles/materials are to be employed for the renovated courts. As I said last night, one fabric applied during one of the past seasons was virtually opaque. It ruined our view. The type used today isn’t great but at least we can kind of see through it to the other side. I’m sure that there can be a design application that not only fulfills its utility role but also appeals to the many constituencies that enjoy the park.

I share some of my fellow neighbors’ concerns at 1140 about the landscaping plans for the surrounding areas of the courts. We’re not opposed to any improvements in aesthetics, only cautious that plantings don’t create any obstructions to views. I know that you’re an expert in this area and again thank you in advance for taking these fundamental elements into account and consideration.

I look forward to tracking the progress of the design process and would be delighted to share any general feedback from our building’s residents when the time is appropriate.

Good luck with the project. I’m sure it’ll be a nice improvement! Please do not hesitate to reach out if I can be of any help.

Take care,

Brad Lucas

1140 Beacon Street



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From: [Fran Perler](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#); [John Shreffler](#); [Ann Frechette](#)
Subject: Amory DRC updated comment
Date: Thursday, March 21, 2024 3:22:29 PM

Hi Jessie,

Good meeting yesterday.

I spoke with the heads of the FoHP Board and they agree with the following, which we would like to be added to the DRC record and sent to the consultants.

The non-boardwalk trails in the Hall's Pond Sanctuary do need an upgrade, but it is important to keep them rustic. Hall's Pond is a WILDLIFE Sanctuary, not a park. Increasing people on the upper trails would be detrimental to migrating and nesting birds if all the folks who use the boardwalk continue onto the upper trails. As a birder, I often see birds frightened away from feeding by the continuous flow of people on the boardwalk. Tom Brady has commented that Hall's Pond is one of the most visited wildlife sanctuaries in the state. We need to keep a quiet area or the birds will loose and stop taking advantage of Hall's Pond. Then we loose.

Thank you for considering this.

Take care,
Fran Perler
Precinct 8 TMM
Council on Aging, Citizen Member
Friends of Hall Pond, Board Member

.....
Sent from Fran's iPad. Language errors courtesy of autocorrect.

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From: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
To: [Blake Migden](#)
Subject: RE: Amory Park Renovations
Date: Monday, March 25, 2024 10:03:00 AM
Attachments: [image001.png](#)
[image002.png](#)
[image003.png](#)

Hi Blake,

Thank you for reaching out. We have just kicked off the design review meetings for Amory last week, so no design work has been done to date. Right now we have a design and drawing set schedule that has the project being put out to bid in early 2025 which would mean construction would start in the spring of 2025. That is about all the information we have at this time though because we need to understand the whole scope of design and construction before we can get into more specific details.

Thank you,

Jessie Waisnor | PLA | CPSI

Senior Landscape Architect

Brookline Department of Public Works | Parks and Open Space Division

333 Washington Street 4th Floor | Brookline, MA 02445

Office: 617-730-2616 Cell: 781-249-2278

Home Office: M&Th 7:30-4:30 and F 7:30-12 Town Hall Office: Tu&W 8-5



From: Blake Migden <[REDACTED]>
Sent: Friday, March 22, 2024 6:13 PM
To: Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov>
Subject: Amory Park Renovations

Hi Jesse!

I hope you are well. I am a current resident in one of the buildings in front of Amory Park. I am thrilled to hear of the park's upcoming renovations but wanted to inquire about the length of the construction project, noise level, and work schedule.

If you have any information on the above I would really appreciate some updates! Thank you!

Warm regards,
Blake

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From: [Elaine Ullian](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Subject: Thank You
Date: Wednesday, March 20, 2024 8:05:32 PM

Good Evening, since you are playing "point" as they say in basketball, I just wanted to weigh in and strenuously object to the proposal for more bike lanes and potential skateboard capacity.

That is not the purpose or intent of this park..

The last thing we need to do is do anything so that it becomes an alternative bike lane for people commuting in Brookline. And skateboarders are not only dangerous around non skateboarding folks, but it's also VERY NOISY.

I concur that the lighting is problematic, especially in the parking lot area.

I don't think there are homes that would be impacted (not sure).

What I was voicing was my concern that the renovation of the tennis courts would include flood lighting that would be very disruptive for those of us who abut the courts.

Thank you for listening; I look forward to working with you and Alexandra.

Best,

Elaine Ullian

1140 Beacon Street

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From: [Tom Johnson](#)
To: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
Cc: [Alexandra Vecchio](#)
Subject: RE: Amory Lighting
Date: Wednesday, March 27, 2024 9:08:03 AM
Attachments: [image002.png](#)
[image003.png](#)
[image004.png](#)

Thanks for passing this along, Jessie. It is a convenience issue, but almost more of a safety concern. As you know, Brookline is a very safe community, but I am pretty big, tough guy and when I walk through this section of the park at night it even makes me a little nervous, I am sure it is even worse for some people.

Thanks again for all the hard work on this project.

Tom Johnson, CAIA
Managing Partner, Client and Corporate Development
Timberland investment Resources, LLC
1330 Beacon Street, Suite 311
Brookline, MA. 02446
www.tirlc.com
Office: 617-264-4769
Cell: 617-320-9570



"When you want to help people, you tell them the truth. When you want to help yourself, you tell them what they want to hear." Thomas Sowell

From: Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov>
Sent: Wednesday, March 27, 2024 8:52 AM
To: Tom Johnson [REDACTED]
Cc: Alexandra Vecchio <avecchio@brooklinema.gov>
Subject: RE: Amory Lighting

Hi Tom,

Thank you for your email. At this time the budget does not include lighting for the park. We will share you email and concerns with the design review committee and consultant team.

Sincerely,

Jessie Waisnor | PLA | CPSI

Senior Landscape Architect

Brookline Department of Public Works | Parks and Open Space Division

333 Washington Street 4th Floor | Brookline, MA 02445

Office: 617-730-2616 Cell: 781-249-2278

Home Office: M&Th 7:30-4:30 and F 7:30-12 Town Hall Office: Tu&W 8-5



From: Tom Johnson [REDACTED]
Sent: Tuesday, March 26, 2024 3:44 PM
To: Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov>
Cc: Alexandra Vecchio <avecchio@brooklinema.gov>
Subject: Amory Lighting

Jessie,

Thanks for the hard work on the Amory Renovation Project. One quick thing to put on your radar. This may be out of scope for the Amory project but for years I have walked through the park at night and the lighting along the pathway, nearer the tennis courts, is good then it disappears and there is a section that is almost pitch black. See attached images. Not sure how this happened but if the plans can include addressing this issue, I think the community would appreciate it.

Cheers,

Tom Johnson, CAIA
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Cell: 617-320-9570



"When you want to help people, you tell them the truth. When you want to help yourself, you tell them what they want to hear." Thomas Sowell

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From: [Jessie Waisnor](#)
To: [Philip Kramer](#)
Subject: RE: Amory renovation thoughts
Date: Tuesday, March 26, 2024 3:40:00 PM
Attachments: [image001.png](#)
[image002.png](#)
[image003.png](#)

Hi Philip,

Thank you for your email I will pass this along to the consultant team. A few notes on some of the items:

Item #4 - The current irrigation system is at the end of its lifespan. The project includes a complete redesign of the system as part of this renovation.

Item #5 - There is currently not money in the budget to support lights but there could be a discussion of adding the underground lines to allow for that as a future addition if budget allows.

Item #6 - There is not money in the budget for this and it is not part of project and would have to go through Recreation.

Item #9 - Due to the proximity to the comfort station and Halls Pond it is not possible to expand the courts. The budget for this project is for the renovation of the courts within the existing footprint.

Item #10 - The construction season will be during typical construction time which is the spring to early winter. Unfortunately there is a large amount of work that is not able to be done once temperatures get colder. There has been no design work done to date so it is difficult to provide a schedule and timeline. Right now the only information we have is that the construction drawings are due to be completed by the end of this calendar year so that would put the project out to bid in early 2025. With a successful bid within budget that would have construction starting in the Spring of 2025. As we get further in the project we will be able to provide more information on what that schedule will look like and involve. There are not plans to renovate any other courts at this time as they are not on the current CIP plan therefore we do not have the budget money for renovations of other courts at this time.

Thank you for your time and commitment to the design review committee and this important park renovation project.

Sincerely,

Jessie Waisnor | PLA | CPSI
Senior Landscape Architect
Brookline Department of Public Works | Parks and Open Space Division
333 Washington Street 4th Floor | Brookline, MA 02445

Office: 617-730-2616 Cell: 781-249-2278

Home Office: M&Th 7:30-4:30 and F 7:30-12 Town Hall Office: Tu&W 8-5



From: Philip Kramer [REDACTED]
Sent: Tuesday, March 26, 2024 10:49 AM
To: Jessie Waisnor <jwaisnor@brooklinema.gov>
Cc: Philip Kramer [REDACTED]
Subject: Re: Amory renovation thoughts

Hi Jessie,

I'm on the DRC for the Amory renovation project. I'm also a longtime tennis player at Amory; I play there 2-3 times a week. I'm also part of the Friends of Amory Tennis, an ad-hoc group that advocates for the Brookline tennis community, especially at Amory, and also at Waldstein.

I spoke briefly at the kickoff DRC meeting and have a few more things I'd like to pass on to the Sasaki team. Some of these are suggestions sent to me as part of FOAT by Amory tennis players.

1. The Amory players play at Amory because of the clay courts. As you no doubt know and also heard at the kickoff meeting, clay is easier on our joints. We really want to keep the clay!
2. Another reason to keep the clay is that, after it rains, the vendor often displaces Amory community tennis players in favor of Waldstein camps because clay courts dry out much faster than hard courts. While Amory community players are, of course, not happy about this displacement, it does work for the vendor and the larger community.
3. A few years ago, Park & Rec put up the nets to protect players on the courts from stray baseballs. They are a good start and we are appreciative, but they are not high enough; many balls come over at every baseball game, with several near misses each season that I have directly heard of, and no doubt many more.
4. The irrigation needs to be upgraded to modern standards. My understanding is that subsurface irrigation is the state of the art for best court conditions and longevity, and allows the most playing time, but may not be suitable in a climate that has freeze cycles. Alternatively, more sprinkler heads and better zoning allows both maximum playing time and best court conditions.
5. These courts are in high demand at many times, especially the end of the workday. We would love to have lights for evening play to make the courts more accessible for after-work play. It would also allow a standardized playing schedule, eliminating some of the seasonal variation and seemingly endless discussion around when "sunset" is and when court play ends each day. I know and understand that the neighbors are concerned about lights, but lights could allow play until, say, 8:00 and stay on until 8:30 for the staff to sweep the courts - that is no later than Summer daylight allows and is still very early in the evening regarding the neighbors who turn in early.
6. A streaming webcam aimed at the courts to get a sense of court status/availability. I'm not sure how to 'see' people who might be waiting out of line-of-sight of the courts, nor how to

address privacy concerns (automation blurring of faces?). This is a good time to say that, while some people might like a reservation system, I think the strong majority prefer the current system, which is "show-up in person, first-come, first-served".

7. Recycling container right at the pro shop for tennis ball cans and beverage containers.
8. Bike racks. The space between the courts and the pro shop is tight, so this may not be feasible.
9. Very long shot given Hall's Pond Sanctuary at the far end of the courts: the court-to-court distance is tight. We definitely want to keep six courts, but if possible, make the spacing larger. There's no question that keeping six tight courts is vastly preferable to wider spacing.
10. Finally, construction timing: there have been many questions as to whether construction can be largely off-season. Assuming that is not going to happen, we'd like to be able to advise the community as soon as possible so they can plan for an alternate playing location. Related to that, we're wondering if the Town could repair other Town courts before construction begins to increase the number of alternate locations.

Many thanks for passing this on!

Philip Kramer
84 Davis Avenue

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Erin Chute
Commissioner

TOWN of BROOKLINE
Massachusetts
Department of Public Works

Amory Playground DRC Kick-off Meeting
Wednesday, March 20th, 2024

Panelists: Alexandra Vecchio, Jessie Waisnor, Sam Downes, Clara Batchelor, Antonia Bellalta, Philip Kramer, Fran Perler, Wyatt Brooks, Jane Flanagan, Andrew Gutterman, Phyllis Zhou, Michael Frechette, Kira Sargent, Zachary Chrisco, Trey Sasser, Kongyun He

Attendees: Elaine Ullian, Olivia Koppell, Ross Yellin, Theresa Mooney, Dina Feith, Richard Schmid, Doris Axelrod, Carine Warsawski, Kim Swartz, Anthony Ishak, Diane Johnson, Nora Sanders

Welcome/Call Meeting to Order

A. Vecchio welcomed all to the meeting. Staff and consultants from Sasaki introduced themselves.

Overview of Project and Scope of Work

A. Gutterman began by briefly reviewing the history of Amory Playground. He remarks upon the central location of Amory Playground and its proximity to various landmarks and transit connections. He notes the 2009 renovation of Amory Playground made improvements to the fields and drainage as well as added a new stair entrance from Amory Street and accessible pathways around the perimeter of the park.

A. Gutterman then identified the current priorities of the project which focus on the areas surrounding the fields. The current priorities are the boardwalks in the Halls Pond and Amory Woods Sanctuary area, the parking lot and entry drive, the tennis courts, and the field house. The team will explore concepts for the future for the hillside landscape that runs parallel to Amory Street.

Review of Existing Conditions

P. Zhou reviewed the existing conditions of the sanctuary boardwalks, parking lot and hillside based on site visits and conversations with the Town. She brought up that the boardwalk's wood surfaces are aged and in poor condition along with the railings and fall protection. She believes that the foundations of the boardwalk seem to be in good condition but will have the engineers verify. She remarks that the connecting paths have uneven surfaces and potholes that will be remedied during the course of the project.

P. Zhou notes that the transition between the parking lot and the gravel area next to the Sanctuary is used for undesired parallel parking creating an undefined drive aisle on the driveway leading to Amory Street and causing erosion along the edge of the Sanctuary. She notes that there are opportunities to improve wayfinding and safety in this area as well as improving amenities. She notes that the hillside landscape has observed erosion issues along the grade change from Amory Street to the ball fields. She brings up that the entrances from Amory Street are only stairs and are not ADA accessible. She remarks that there are mature canopy trees that provide good shade but have limited seating opportunities beneath them.

T. Sasser reviewed the existing conditions of the tennis courts. He noted that the clay surfaces of the tennis courts are nearing the end of their useful lifespan and they will be looking at the surface as well as the fences and amenities around the courts. He notes that there is one main entrance to the courts and they would like to add a maintenance entrance that is separate from the main entrance and more easily accessible. He mentions that they will be looking at the erosion of the surface materials and the areas around the courts. He remarks that there is tight spacing around the courts as well as the entrance from Beacon Street that passes by the courts that they will be looking at improvements for alongside the trees in the area.

M. Frechette reviewed the existing conditions of the field house. He noted that while the structure itself is robust, they are looking at ways the enclosure and usability can be improved. They have seen water infiltration issues at both the lower storage and pro shop areas as well as the upper restrooms. He remarks that there are ways to improve the hardscaping at the edges of the building to prevent the existing grading from bringing water inside under the door sills. He mentioned that neither of the two bathrooms have accessible stalls and have aging as well as missing fixtures inside. He finishes with noting that they will be taking a closer look at the utility systems located in the field house and the organization of them from an operational viewpoint.

Community Discussion and Feedback

K. Sargent then presented multiple polls to get feedback on various community sentiment. The first poll was “How often do you visit the park?” with the following responses:

- A Daily or a couple times a week (60%)
- B Weekly (24%)
- C Monthly (8%)
- D A couple times a year (8%)
- E Never visited (0%)

The second poll was “How do you usually get to Amory?” with the following responses:

- A Walk or Jog (76%)
- B Bike (14%)
- C Train or Bus (0%)
- D Car (10%)

The third poll was “What do you usually do at Amory? Choose up to 3 activities.” With the following responses:

- A Play Tennis (8%)
- B Informal Sports on the Field (3%)
- C Organized Sports on the Field (0%)
- D Dog Walk (15%)
- E Visit Hall’s Pond Sanctuary (24%)

F Walk or Jog (26%)
G Community Event (3%)
H Picnic, Relax, or Hangout (21%)

The fourth poll was “What is your favorite place at Amory?” with the following responses:

A Field (23%)
B Tennis Court (18%)
C Hillside (9%)
D Sanctuary Boardwalk and Pond (45%)
E Sanctuary Formal Gardens (5%)

The fifth poll was “What do you consider to be the most important priorities for this renovation? Choose up to 3.” With the following responses:

A Parking lot (15%)
B Boardwalk (31%)
C Field House (11%)
D Tennis Courts (17%)
E Developing a hillside landscape (26%)

The sixth poll was “Which of these outcomes are the most appealing to you? Choose up to 3.” With the following responses:

A Improve paths and circulation (35%)
B Improve park entrances (7%)
C Add areas to play and gather on the hillside (9%)
D Add more trees and plantings (25%)
E Add/improve amenities like seating and bike racks (25%)

F. Perler remarked that the boardwalk surfaces are in very bad condition and need frequent repair. She brought up that the fence separating the sanctuary area from the rest of the park has had multiple trees fall on it recently and is taped. She notes that the accessible restrooms and flat paths are appreciated by the seniors who use the park and they would like to see more benches so people can stop to rest or enjoy the park.

C. Batchelor remarked that part of the appeal of Amory Playground is that it is relatively undeveloped which helps its beauty. She wishes to see repairs made but would like to see the hillside stay undeveloped. She notes that she wishes to see the improvements to the facilities but does not want to see additional facilities added.

F. Perler noted that the Hall’s Pond is an official wildlife sanctuary and is concerned about the use separation between the park area and the sanctuary area.

P. Kramer remarked that he wishes to see tennis court improvements as he uses the courts frequently. He noted that he sees many people relaxing on the hillside currently. He suggested adding an outdoor adult exercise station similar to the facilities around Jamaica Pond.

A. Bellalta noted that she does not feel that the current entrances to the park are very welcoming and wishes to see improvements to the entrance areas. She suggested adding more wayfinding to help show the amenities that the park offers. She is concerned about the condition of the field house.

P. Kramer noted that there were nets recently placed over the fencing around the tennis courts to prevent baseballs from flying in and wants to be sure that it is addressed. He notes that these are the only clay tennis courts in Brookline and notes that they are popular because of that as it is easier on user's joints. C. Batchelor also raises the question of whether the tennis courts will stay clay or be replaced with asphalt. A. Vecchio remarked that the decision of materials used for the courts will be decided over the course of the design review process and will be presented by Sasaki.

F. Perler and C. Batchelor reiterated their concerns about over-developing the park and that they wish to see it remain as is in terms of facilities. C. Batchelor noted that the hillside is used as a sledding hill during the winter.

E. Ullian, a Beacon St resident, expressed concerns about the lighting improvements leaking into their home as they live adjacent to the tennis courts.

D. Axelrod asked how Amory will be improved as a dog park and how abutters will be considered during construction. A. Gutterman noted that as the design process gets further along, those considerations will be put into the construction documents such as limitations around hours, notifications and screening. A. Vecchio remarked that the project scope does not include the fields for dog park improvements but does include path circulation. D. Axelrod also notes that more benches and seating would be appreciated, especially in shaded areas.

O. Koppell notes that she enjoys the park as it is structured but wishes to see maintenance over adding to or changing the park in significant ways. She suggests adding signs both for dog owners/circulation as well as for public events and more organized sports or activities. She wondered how long construction/disruption will end up taking. A. Vecchio notes that construction timelines are hard to predict so early in the design phase. She remarks that the ideal would be phased construction but that would also require a longer timeline to complete.

R. Yellen and D. Johnson remarked that they wish to see the tennis courts improved but do not want them changed from clay. A. Gutterman noted that it is too early in the design process to nail down any hard design choices but that the feedback will inform their decisions.

A. Ishak, a resident of Freeman St, remarked that he bicycled using the path through Amory Park commuting to Longwood Medical Area as he felt it was safer than biking down Amory St then onto Beacon St. He wishes to see a bike maintenance facility added with tire pumps and hanging chains as it would improve safety and would not take up too much square footage. Wishes to see the paths improved for multi-modal access such as bicycles and skateboards. He notes that he appreciates that the exit to the parking lot is uphill as it helps calm traffic and makes the intersection safer. He wishes to see this exit remain at a similar grade to what currently exists. He suggests adding a small community garden area to the gravel section between the parking lot and the Ivy Street School.

C. Warsawski is concerned about the lack of lighting at night as it can feel unsafe currently. She also wishes to see the paths widened as some paths are not wide enough to allow two people to pass each other while staying on the path. She remarked that the hillside has a good view of the Town's skyline and wants to see that preserved. She hopes that some picnic benches could be installed similar to the ones used at Waldstein Playground.

B. Lucas, an abutter to the tennis courts, wishes to see the windscreens on the tennis court fences be more translucent as its opaqueness impedes their view.

N. Sanders expressed desire to see the tennis courts remain clay.

R. Yellen noted that many tennis players wish to see the tennis courts remain clay and that they prefer the clay courts to the asphalt courts at Waldstein. He also notes that clay courts can be maintained better than asphalt courts despite their higher cost.

D. Feith expressed desire for improved lighting in the park and along Amory Street.

D. Johnson wishes to see tennis court improvements similar to what was implemented at Fisher Hill Park.

F. Perler expressed concerns that improved lighting might negatively impact the wildlife sanctuary portion of the park.

Next Steps and Upcoming Meeting Dates

A. Gutterman noted that he appreciates the feedback and that they will be coming up with preliminary options and ideas for the parks over the next five weeks.

Adjournment

The meeting was adjourned.